WINTER IN OUR BONES
WATER TO OUR SOULS



MICHIGAN

THE MUSICAL

When a data center threatens their grandparents' lake house, Lulu and Petoskey – a fierce Dearborn city girl and hopeful Yooper farm boy – must conquer years of grief to save their home... and the world.

Michigan

Michigan

Inspired by

The MacGregor Family

David Quang Pham's Childhood

&

In Loving Memory of

Carly Glynn
September 24, 1992 – February 10, 2011

Gerald Fick
November 29, 1962 – May 11, 2017

Jeremy Swiatek
April 23, 1996 - September 15, 2019

Tiffany Marie Emmert
April 29, 1996 – January 19, 2026

James Emmert
May 5, 1991 – January 19, 2026

Andrew Van Otteren
March 17, 1994 - July 12, 2026

Because of you, David and many others love musicals and Michigan.

THANK YOU

Dramaturgy 2026-Now

Ynika Yuag

Feedback 2026-Now

Marilyn Chau, Lukas Jacob, Dionne O'Dell, May Perez, Mia Soriano, Dr. Daniel Smith, Camille Thomas

Harlem Writers United 2026

Alexandra Williams-Fleck, Karen Chien, Michael

DEVELOPMENT

Theatre People Salon with Jen & Matt Coogan 8/30/2026

Beth Barton, Denise Gillott, Kayla Katona, Andrea Rae, Jake Sheffer

Cultivate Theatre Project Seeding the Science Workshop 10/24/2026

Kate Douglas, Sarah Kozlow, Rachel Leighson

SYNOPSIS

When a data center threatens their grandparents' lake house, Lulu and Petoskey – a fierce Dearborn city girl and hopeful Yooper farm boy – must conquer years of grief to save their home... and the world. Set during a family reunion in Elk Rapids, this folksy musical dramedy follows the Van Otterloo family rallying the community against a predatory tech giant. Driven by her brother's death in the Great Lakes, the company's grieving founder uses AI avatars of dead members of the Van Otterloos to steal their land and drain the lakes as environmental vendetta. Lulu, "pearl" in Arabic, is a metaphor for those who try to break out of their shells. Petoskey, the native fossil that reveals its true pattern in water, serves as a metaphor for ancestry, memory, and grief.

Michigan is inspired by David Quang Pham's upbringing and the MacGregors who invite him to celebrate Harbor Days at their lake house in Elk Rapids since being college roommates with their family member Lukas Jacob in 2014. In 2026, after a series of tragedies of his hometown and college theatre friends, he wrote this musical as a love letter to his family and communities in our home Mitten.

WHY NOW?

Michigan champions creativity, connections, and the environment against the rise of harmful technologies, symbolized by data centers taking over Michigan towns. By focusing on collective loss, the musical addresses today's mental health crisis, offering ways to heal through open communication and community. And it uses science and folklore to engage audiences in environmental and cultural literacy.

Michigan is *Oklahoma* craziness meets *Fun Home* tenderness meets *Bright Star* folksiness.

READ THE PITCH DECK

THEMES

Collective Grief and Emotional Healing

The story explores the long-term impact of grief after some family members' passings, demonstrating how silence fractures families while open communication fosters generational healing.

Community versus Corporation

The central conflict pits hand-made tradition against corporate greed, with data centers erasing local heritage, such as the family's lake house.

Geographic and Cultural Disconnection

The narrative highlights how families can become polarized by peninsulas, symbolized by the physical (and spiritual) barrier of the Mackinac Bridge separating the Upper and Lower Peninsula. The story leans into subcultures, pitting Yoopers against the Trolls.

Belonging and Identity

Through Lulu's competitive drive to outshine her cousins, the musical examines the painful adolescent struggle to fit into a Midwest family dynamic and find one's own sense of worth.

Nature, Folklore, and Science Literacy

The musical teaches paleontology, folklore, and what it means to be a Michigander through song.

The Immigrant Experience

This manifests through multiple layers, such as Shelby marrying an Arab man, Jasper Vinh Chin's Vietnamese restaurant (Banh MIchigan), and his realization that his refugee family stayed united across continents while local families are divided by peninsulas. It deals heavily with how different minority communities interact within the Midwest.

Economic Displacement and Xenophobia

The backstory reveals the harsh realities of blue-collar job loss during the 2008 recession, like David's own family in the automotive industry. It directly addresses the displaced anger that can arise from automated or immigrant replacement (Petey being fired and replaced by a migrant worker), showing the tragic intersection of economic desperation, racial tension, and family fallout.

The Power of Hand-Made Artistry

The family's century-old Ford Model T, their decades of hand-made costumes, and the town's rally around them showcase art and weirdness as a form of liberation.

Healing through Artistry, Spirituality, or Technology

Due to sharing the same tragedy involving the Mackinac Bridge. Amanda and Liz never crossed that bridge for years. Amanda also has disdain for water, so she makes more data centers to drain them. Amanda processes grief by losing artistry through AI while Cherry becomes more artistic and less tech-savvy.

Michigan

PLOT SUMMARY

Michigan is a folksy musical dramedy set at a family reunion where two rival cousins fight a data center to save their grandparents' lake house and world. The themes explore grief, cultural disconnection of the peninsulas, and what it means to be a Michigander.

Grampy Willy and Granny Milly live in Elk Rapids on the north tip of the Lower Peninsula. They have four adult children – Cherry, Perry, Shelby, and the only son Petey, and some grandchildren. Every August, their Lake House lodges them for the annual Harbor Days. The Van Otterloo family is known for their century-old Ford Model T, wearing themed costumes for the parade, and winning every Most Creative Award ("The Mitten Song").

In 2008, Petey lives with his pregnant wife Lizzie in the Upper Peninsula. His childhood friend is Jasper Vinh Chin, who runs the Elk Rapids Vietnamese restaurant, BANH MIchigan. On a swim, he jokily promises to name their kid after the first rock he picks up, which turns out to be a heart-shaped Petoskey with an elk symbol ("Life is Complete").

With the recession, their shipyard job fires and replaces Petey and Liz with migrants. He then hurts his little sister Shelby due to her Arab husband. In a storm, he drives off the Mackinac Bridge to save their house on his life insurance. A detective finds his Petoskey. Ever since, Liz refuses to cross bridges, missing all family gatherings ("Body of Water").

For family reunions, the aunts take turns driving Petoskey to Elk Rapids then Milly drives him home. Jasper becomes his godfather. For every Mackinac Bridge crossing, he can hear his dad sing. And then there's his bright cousin from Dearborn, Lulu Abughosh. She always competes to find the rarest stones on their swims ("Yoopers and Trolls").

In 2020, Milly passes away, cancelling the 2020 and 2021 family reunions. Soon, data center agent Amanda Wayland tricks a grieving Willy into signing away the deed to his house by using Afterlife.AI to bring Milly and Petey back to life ("It Would Be a Shame").

In 2022, to honor Milly, 13-year-old Petoskey's mom returns for the first time since '08. They drive the long way through Wisconsin. Jasper helps the kids set up camp. He takes their snacks as "dad tax." The aunties take even more with "mom taxes" ("Dad Tax").

Though the family gather by the bonfire, 13-year-old Lulu is in her tent finishing a song. She revisits a time when she ran away and was saved from a car accident by deer. She thinks everyone sees her as a loser. She'd do anything to win their hearts ("Dearborn").

They realize Amanda tricked Willy into trading the Lake House for her AI that "brings loved ones back to life." She tours the home and sees a photo of Petoskey's heirloom. She wants it more than anything. So, he promises to trade it for the deed ("AI Does the Work for Me").

They need to find it in Pine River ("Wild Midwest"). He revisits a memory of Lulu losing the heirloom while canoeing in 2019, severing his dad's spiritual ties. So, he gathers everyone to find it. No one does ("Fish for Mom and Dad").

Michigan

Later that night on a dune, Lulu witnesses a deer pass by their bonfire. Next day, while Perry teaches fossils to the kids ("Time Does Heal"), Lulu separates and discovers a deer dropping off the heirloom and other rare rocks on the shore ("Gichigamiin").

After successfully bulldozing Ypsilanti, Amanda revisits a time when she and her techy brother were artists until his suicide killed her creative spirit ("The Starving Artist").

For Harbor Days' parade, Broadway actor cousin Jacob Jacobowitz is the Grand Marshal. So, the theme is theatre. Petoskey dresses as *Oklahoma*'s Jud Fry while Lulu plays Evan Hansen. Before marching, she shows her rare findings to the family. To spite Petoskey, she breaks his father's necklace, unaware it was their only chance to save the Lake House from Amanda. The parade goes wrong as Petoskey beats up Lulu, disqualifying them for the first time ("Fraudway"). After his mom lectures him, he runs off ("Kick Rocks").

In the following act, Liz revisits a memory of Lulu and Petoskey at a talent show ("Hands Come in Handy"). Presently, she searches for him while Lulu tries to find him at Banh MI ("Petoskey"). Jasper shares his refugee family stayed united despite continents dividing them as well as a time when a Lebanese family bought out his family's failing restaurant but did not resort to blame as Petey had. The Van Otterloos are only divided by peninsulas. They realize Petoskey is at the Mackinac Bridge ("North South East West"). Meanwhile, Liz revisits her marriage proposal to Petey on a boat under it ("Natural Beauty").

They drive up to find him. She offers the broken stone as a truce, but he tosses it into the water ("Rock Bottom"). This causes the bridge to fog up where Michilimackinac, the Great Turtle appears. They share that stones are like family as they come and go to leave a mark. And they ask the kids to stop the data centers around Michigan due to its harm on the environment and its noisiness ("Family's in the Fossils").

They return to the fair where Amanda exhibits data center models for the oligarchs. Jasper offers his restaurant for the Lake House. The Van Otterloos return with years of costume while Amanda shows how much "better" AI is. But the town rallies for this creatively weird family, against AI's goal of turning lakes into data centers. Amanda and the crew steal the Ford, causing the town to chase after them. Liz, on her way to the Mackinac Bridge, tricks Amanda's GPS AI to go there. Her trauma causes her to crash off the side of the bridge. Everyone gets off, but the Ford falls into the strait below ("Leave No Stones Unturned").

It has been years since the death of their loved ones that Liz and Amanda have visited the Mackinac Bridge. In unison, the Van Otterloos and Amanda cross it, where they reunite with the souls of Petey and Conor. Amanda cancels her agreement to keep the Lake House. Elk Rapids is spared from a data center ("Water to My Soul").

Years later, Willy passes away. Lulu and Petoskey buy and fix up the Lake House. On January 26, 2037, Lansing holds a parade to celebrate the 200th anniversary of MI's statehood with representatives from every city marching. The theme is Pure Michigan. Representing Elk Rapids, the Van Otterloo family resembles the state's best ("Michigan").

CAST OF CHARACTERS

THE VAN OTTERLOO FAMILY

LULU VAN OTTERLOO ABUGHOSH describes herself as a Middle Eastern girl in the middle of the Midwestern world. A 13-year-old born and raised in Dearborn, she wears solid colors, hoping to collect better rocks than Cousin Petoskey every year. She is writing *Dearborn*, a musical about deer navigating the talking Great Lakes. She plays banjo and is Iggy Pop's biggest fan. Her name is Arabic meaning "pearl."

PETOSKEY VAN OTTERLOO describes himself as a rocky Yooper farm boy skipping the Great Lakes water. A 13-year-old from Skandia, he wears patterns and trapper hats. He connects with his ancestors through his heart-shaped Petoskey heirloom with an elk symbol. He loves to go fishing; he just needs a parent to do it with.

LIZZIE GLYNN VAN OTTERLOO is Petoskey's mother and narrator in Skandia. After a tragedy in 2008, she stops crossing the Mackinac Bridge to attend Harbor Days and family gatherings. Liz is a proud Yooper and shipbuilder. Michigan State.

PETEY VAN OTTERLOO is Petoskey's father, Liz's husband, and Willy and Milly's only son of four. During the recession, his and Liz's blue-collar shipyard job replaces them with migrants. His spirit lives within Petoskey. Michigan State.

SHELBY VAN OTTERLOO ABUGHOSH is Petoskey's aunt, Petey's little sister, and Lulu's mother in Dearborn. She is a Ford Motor worker. As the family member who broke the mold by being a Midwesterner who fell in love with a Middle Easterner, she and Petey has a tumultuous relationship. Kettering University.

PERRY VAN OTTERLOO is Petoskey's aunt and Petey's campy sister in Lansing. Her heart is in science, yet she has a conspiracy theory mindset and plotted to kidnap the governor. Michigan Technological University and Eastern Michigan dropout.

CHERRY VAN OTTERLOO JACOBOWITZ is Petoskey's aunt and Petey's oldest sister in Kalamazoo. She arranges the theme and costumes for the annual Harbor Days parade. She is married to a Grand Rapids Griffins hockey manager. Hope College.

JACOB VAN OTTERLOO JACOBOWITZ is Cherry's son who is a Broadway actor in New York. He is the 2022 Grand Marshal for the Harbor Days Grande Parade where he is dressed as Wednesday from *The Addams Family*. He recently performed on the national tour of this show. Western Michigan University.

LIBERTY AND **BAILEY VAN OTTERLOO** are twin siblings and Petoskey, Lulu, and Jacob's little cousins removed from reality. They are from Hell… Michigan.

Michigan

MILLY VAN OTTERLOO is Petoskey's bold grandmother and inventor. She invented the auto-toilet. With Willy, she owns a Lake House by Elk Lake in Elk Rapids. She and Willy stumble into the audience every so often. Central Michigan.

WILLY VAN OTTERLOO is Petoskey's chill grandfather and gardener. With Milly, he owns a Lake House by Elk Lake in Elk Rapids. He and Milly stumble into the audience every so often. Northern Michigan University.

MICHIGANDERS

JASPER VINH CHIN is Petey's resourceful childhood friend and Petoskey's godfather/godmother who runs the BANH MIchigan Vietnamese restaurant and a golf course. As a teen, they once looked down on the migrant community when a Lebanese family bought out his family's original struggling restaurant. Ferris State.

AMANDA WAYLAND is the CEO of Turkey Ventures from Muskegon with the goal of turning every lake city into a data center. Following her brother Conor's death, she loses her creative spirit and takes over her brother's business to create Afterlife.AI to bring late loved ones back as avatars. She was an art school rival of Cherry, before getting expelled. Hope College dropout. University of Michigan.

DETECTIVE is an investigator along the Mackinac Bridge.

THE GHOST OF HENRY FORD returns from Hell.

MICHILIMACKINAC, the Mackinac spirit resembling the Great Turtle.

THE KEEPERS OF FAITH, FIRE, TRADE are the original people of the land

MICHIGANDERS, **RESIDENTS, LAWMAKERS**, **OLIGARCHS**, **RADIO**, anyone who speaks in "ope."

Michigan

MUSICAL NUMBERS

ACT I

1. Overture / The Mitten Song Petey
2. Life is Complete Michiganders
3. Body of Water Petey, Lizzie, Detective, Mackinac Ghosts
4. Yoopers and Trolls Petoskey, Lulu, Cherry, Perry, Shelby, Milly, Willy
5. It Would Be a Shame Amanda, Willy, Milly, Petey
6. Dad Tax Jasper, Lizzie, Cherry, Perry, Shelby, Lulu, Petoskey, Jacob, Liberty, Bailey
7. Dearborn Lulu, Van Otterloos, Deer
8. AI Does the Work for Me Amanda, Van Otterloos
9. Wild Midwest Jacob, Petoskey, Lulu, Liberty, Bailey, Cousins
10. Fish for Mom and Dad Jacob, Petoskey, Lulu, Liberty, Bailey, Cousins
11. Time Does Heal Perry, Lulu, Petoskey, Cousins
12. Gichigamiin (The Great Lakes Ballet) Lulu, Keepers, Explorers
13. The Starving Artist Amanda
14. Fraudway Van Otterloos
15. Kick Rocks Van Otterloos, Keepers of Faith Fire Trade

ACT II

16. Hands Come in Handy Lulu, Petoskey
17. Petoskey Lizzie, Amanda, Van Otterloos
18. North South East West Jasper, Lulu, Jacob
19. Natural Beauty Lizzie, Petey
20. Rock Bottom Petoskey, Lulu, Jasper, Mackinac Ghosts
21. Family's in the Fossils Michilimackinac, Petoskey, Lulu
22. Leave No Stones Unturned Amanda, Van Otterloos, Michiganders
23. Water to My Soul Lizzie, Petey, Van Otterloos, Amanda, Michilimackinac, Mackinac Ghosts
24. Michigan Michiganders

MICHIGAN THEMES

Nayaano	Water Spirits	Lake Giants
Main Theme	Childhood Theme	Adulthood Theme
Pine Monsters	Wind Hoppers	Michilimackinac
Troublesome Theme	Migration Theme	Nature Theme

PROLOGUE

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE IN ELK RAPIDS - AUGUST 2008 - DAY

1. "OVERTURE/THE MITTEN SONG"

The lights come up on the most naturally beautiful scenery. Next to the shores of Elk Lake, the VAN OTTERLOOS camp in their tents. The old Lake House sits behind them.

PETEY (30s, boisterous man) bursts out of his tent, wearing oversized mittens. With a yawn, he bangs pots and pans to wake the campsite.

PETEY
WAKEY WAKEY, SUN.
LET'S WEAR OUR MITTENS
AND COOK 'EM EGGS WITH LOTSA BACON
FOR OUR GODSEND, MICHIGAN!
SLEPT WELL, HUN...?

LIZZIE (30s, pregnant) crawls out of Petey's tent, holding a shoe, ready to smack her noisy hubby.

End of "OVERTURE/THE MITTEN SONG"

2. "LIFE IS COMPLETE"

LIZZIE
(Narrating)
PETEY... THE LOVE OF MY LIFE.
BUT EVERY MORNING, HE'S PUBLIC ENEMY NUMBER ONE.

The three Van Otterloo sisters - CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY (pregnant) - crawl out of their tents.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
TO HIS WIFE, LIZZIE...

PETEY
...AND ONE TWO AND THREE LOONEY SISTERS!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
THE VAN OTTERLOO SISTERS!

CHERRY
CHERRY!

PERRY
PERRY!

SHELBY
SHELBY!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
WET WILLY!

PETEY
Eeeekkkkk!!!

The Sisters give Bro a wet willy as GRANNY MILLY and GRAMPY WILLY roam in the Audience.

WILLY
DID SOMEONE SAY WET WILLY?!

MILLY
OR WET MILLY?

PETEY, CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
EW... MOM AND DAD, THAT'S GROSS!

WILLY
WHAT?!

MILLY
HUH?!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
GO PUT ON YOUR HEARING AIDS.

The Couple tune their hearing aids.

WILLY & MILLY
GREAT!

MILLY
GRAMPY WILLY.
WE'VE GOT COMPANY.

WILLY
GRANNY MILLY.
REAL GOOD COMPANY.

WILLY & MILLY
AIN'T LIFE SOMETHIN'?

MILLY
YOU HAVE COME A LONG WAY, FRIENDS.

WILLY
TO THE GREATEST BAY IN ALL THE GREAT LAKES!

MILLY
BAKED YOUR KIDS FRESH COOKIES,
MAKE YOURSELF COMFY.

Milly hands out cookies. Willy removes his shoes. The Pit pukes.

MILLY (CONT'D)
Ugh! Ya scaring our guests with your clam feet!

WILLY
I've been working out. My legs are made of mussels. M-U-S-S-E-L-S? Get it?

MILLY
Your dad jokes are getting old, Grampy Willy.

WILLY
Not as old as you, Granny Milly...

MILLY
Shush! Our guests will think the Midwest's sill-

LIZZIE
Midwest? Silly? Same thing. If you ain't ever visit, our hands are our maps. Down here is the Mitten, where most of the family live. Up here, past Mackinac Bridge, is the Upper Peninsula where Petey and I build ships and try to survive the winters. But every August, the Van Otterloo family travels from all corners of the state to meet here in Elk Rapids to celebrate-

VAN OTTERLOOS EXCEPT LIZ
Harbor Days! Who are you talking to?

LIZZIE
Seriously you ask me, but not Willy or Milly?

WILLY & MILLY
Lizzie's a keeper, Petey. Maestro?!
LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH OUR CRAZY FAMILY!

The family put on Red Wings gears.

LIZZIE
Each summer, I've been going to Petey's family reunions since we were high school sweethearts. And while tailgating Michigan State University-

PETEY
Go Green!

AUDIENCE
Go White!

LIZZIE
...and I still have no clue what Harbor Days is even about.

CHERRY
It's about the parade, sweetheart.

PERRY
Nah, it's about the carnival, yo!

SHELBY
Actually, it's about the fireworks, deary!

WILLY & MILLY
It’s about Lake House we built!

WILLY
And our koi pond! Milly, did you put a turtle in it? She ate all of our koi fish!

CHERRY
It's my son, Jacob. Little teenage rascal...

LIZZIE
Petey's oldest sister, Cherry Van Otterloo Jacobowitz. Her family’s in Kalamazoo. She's a costume designer and her hubby played hockey with the Grand Rapids Griffins.

Cherry shows Kalamazoo on her hand.

CHERRY
The only pucks I give is winning another Most Creative Award at the annual Grande Parade.

LIZZIE
Ever since she was little, Cherry would make the family wear elaborate costumes.

CHERRY
2008 is Red Wings’s year.

PETEY
They just beat Pittsburgh Penguins...

SHELBY
...to win the Stanley Cup. Woop!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
NO ONE BEATS THE VAN OTTERLOOS!

LIZZIE
No one beats us like this 2008 recession. Michigan's been hit hard. Budget’s tight. The docks in Marquette fired me and Petey. We can only hope that we don't lose our house.

PERRY
If this scavenger has kept her den, any other coyote can.

LIZZIE
This is Perry. She and Petey, middle children.

PERRY
I’m in the middle of greatness!

LIZZIE
Single. College dropout. Can never hold a job.

PERRY
I work at Lansing Impression Science Center!

Perry shows Lansing on her hand.

LIZZIE
Welp, she's the smartest person I know.

SHELBY
What does that make me?

LIZZIE
Pregnancy sistahs!

SHELBY
Whoo yeah!

LIZZIE
Shelby Van Otterloo Abughosh, Petey's youngest sister. How's Ford in Dearborn holding up?

Shelby shows Dearborn on her hand.

SHELBY
Assembly line's fine, thanks to my husband. He got his Kurdish friends jobs. Minimum wage, but what more could one ask for in recession times?

PETEY
Middle Easterners stealing Midwest jobs-

LIZZIE
(Narrating)
Midwesterners love everyone- *Middle Easterners*?
(to Petey)
Petey... Her husband never attends Harbor Days thanks to that attitude of yours.

PETEY
He married Shelby for citizenship. He'd dump her when he gets the chance.

SHELBY
Immigrants built the coasts, harbors, country.

LIZZIE
Only community can outlast an economic crash!

The Michigan communities from the Midwesterners to Middle Easterners, auto workers to farmers, college sport fans to trade school artisans make themselves known.

MICHIGANDERS
OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE! OPE!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE...

LIZZIE
WITHOUT...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
COMMUNITY!

MICHIGANDERS
COMMUNITY!

MICHIGANDERS (CONT'D)
THE WORLD SITS ON OUR FURNITURE!
PEOPLE CAN GET ANYWHERE IN OUR CARS!
OUR CHERRY FARMS ARE THE CHERRY ON TOP!

JASPER VINH CHIN (30s, Vietnamese) opens the BANH MI restaurant.

JASPER
AND LET'S NOT FORGET!

PETEY
ELK RAPIDS HAS THE BEST VIETNAMESE RESTAURANT!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
MICHIGAN HAS THE BEST VIETNAMESE COMMUNITY!

JASPER
IN THE WHOLE WORLD!

MICHIGANDERS
LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE WITHOUT BANH MI!

JASPER
BANH MIIIIIIIIIIICHIGAN!

MICHIGANDERS
SAY THAT AGAIN!

JASPER
BANH MICHIGAN!
BANH MIchigan, a Vietnamese family-owned restaurant in Elk Rapids, Michigan. Home to Banh Mi Thit, Mi Heo, Mi Xiu Mai, Mi Ga Nuong, and home to our latest Detroit-style Banh Mi-

PETEY
Banh Mi is also what I called home. Jasper!

JASPER
Petey! Happy Harbor Days to you, and Lizzie, and your soon-to-be baby!

LIZZIE
Got any Banh Mi baby formula?

JASPER
Way ahead of ya!

PETEY
Come on by the Lake House for o' time sake.

JASPER
Kosher Banh Mi for Cherry's son Jacob and sourdough for Willy and Milly?

PETEY
With this recession, I don't know if we can afford to break those special kinds of bread.

JASPER
To me, the Van Otterloos bred the most special folks in my- *our* lives. Banh Mi's always on me.

Perry fidgets with a radio.

VAN OTTERLOOS
LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE WITHOUT...

PERRY
RIGHT WING RADIO!

LIZZIE
Every family needs the crazy aunt...

PETEY, CHERRY, SHELBY
What's wrong with you?

PERRY
I'll tell you what's wrong: anything not right.

AMANDA WAYLAND (30s, all business) gets on stage for an interview.

RADIO (O.S.)
Here on *The Patriot* is a special guest: Amanda Wayland, CEO of the creative startup, Turkey Ventures. First, we express our condolences.

CHERRY
My art nemesis...

AMANDA
Life's been incomplete without Conor. To fight grief- Life can be made complete again with AI.

RADIO
(Laughing)
It's 2008. Not 2080. AI is going nowhere.

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O PERRY
What's so funny? AI...?

PERRY
Artificial intelligence.

CHERRY
If she had real intelligence, she wouldn't have been expelled from art school at Hope College-

PERRY
Cut her some slack. She lost all hope.

CHERRY
I'd cut her for stabbing me in the back. Boo hoo, she lost her artistic integrity too.

AMANDA & VAN OTTERLOOS
LIFE AIN'T COMPLETE WITHOUT ENEMIES AND RIVALRIES.

Willy drives in the Ford Model T.

WILLY
AND OUR FORD MODEL T!

MICHIGANDERS
THE FORD MODEL T!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
DADDY GOT SOME WHEELIES.

MICHIGANDERS (CONT'D)
WILLY GOT SOME WHEELIES.

WILLY & MILLY
THIS BABY'S JUST A CENTURY YOUNG.

Liz, Petey, Shelby, and Jasper hang out by Elk Lake.

LIZZIE
Watcha naming your daughter?

LULU's shadow manifests.

SHELBY
Lulu! It means "pearl." And your ibnuki (إِبْنُكِ)?

Petey looks disgusted.

LIZZIE
Lulu is jameela (جميلة). No clue.

JASPER
I bet Petey's got an ace up his sleeves.

PETEY
More like *stone*.

Petey and Jasper hop into Elk Lake, splashing each other.

PETEY (CONT'D)
We won't name our son. A rock in Elk Lake will!

Petey dives into Elk Lake.

JASPER
Jasper! *Jasper*! *Jasper*!

LIZZIE
This gotta be a joke...

Petey resurfaces with a heart-shaped stone with an Elk mark.

PETOSKEY's shadow manifests.

MICHIGANDERS
(Gospel)
PETOSKEY...
PETOSKEY...
THE JEWEL OF MICHIGAN...

LIZZIE
WE AIN'T NAMING OUR SON THAT.

JASPER
How about naming your second kid, Jasper?!

PETEY
WE DON'T HAVE TO NAME HIM PET-

Liz kisses Petey. They join the rest of the family, marching in the Harbor Days Grande Parade.

LIZZIE
ISN'T LIFE BEAUTIFUL?

PETEY (CONT'D)
ISN'T LIFE WORTH LIVING?

VAN OTTERLOOS
LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH OUR

MICHIGANDERS
LIFE IS COMPLETE WITH THIS

LIZZIE
CRAZY

PETEY
SASSY

CHERRY
WORKY

PERRY
NERDY

SHELBY
DERPY

WILLY
WILLY

MILLY
LOVELY

JASPER & MICHIGANDERS
WELCOMING...

VAN OTTERLOOS
FAMILY!

The Michiganders give Milly the Most Creative Award plaque.

End of “LIFE IS COMPLETE”

Liz’s phone rings. She answers.

LIZZIE
No! Please! Life is incomplete without it!

Liz slams her flip phone. She nod at Petey. He holds her close.

PETEY
Our house? No no no. Rest assured, all that matters is that we have our lives ahead.

Liz lets go. She exits with everyone clearing the parade.

PETEY (CONT’D)
We ain’t losing our house... I’ve got my life insurance... Let’s trade.

Elk Lake becomes Mackinac Strait.

EXT. MACKINAC BRIDGE - EVENING

3. “BODY OF WATER”

In the foggy storm, Petey ponders.

PETEY
EVERY LIVING THING IS MADE OF WATER.
EVERY MACHINERY NEEDS THE FLOW OF WATER.
ALL THE WEATHER TAKE THE HEATED WATER.
ALL THE SEASONS BRING THE COOLING WATER.

I BRING NOTHING TO THE WORLD UNLIKE WATER.
I’VE BROUGHT NOTHING TO THE WORLD BUT TEARS!

The MACKINAC GHOSTS manifest, resembling those who died there.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
DRINK IT. DRINK THE WATER.
THINK STRAIGHT. THINK STRAIGHTFORWARD.

PETEY
I BRING NOTHING TO THE WORLD.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
CHERISH. CHERISH THIS ONE LIFE.

PETEY
JUST TEARS!
HELP!

The Ghosts steal Petey's stone.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
HELP? HELL, HELP YOURSELF!

A Motherly Ghost returns with a Petoskey necklace. Petey wears it.

PETEY
I CHOOSE LIFE!

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)
TAKE IT IN.

PETEY (CONT'D)
DRINK THE GREAT LAKES WATER.
THINK PAIN. PAIN YOU'LL CAUSE.
HAPPY WIFE. BABY IN SIGHT. DYING AIN'T RIGHT.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
DRINK IT. DRINK THE WATER.
THINK STRAIGHT. THINK STRAIGHTFORWARD.
CHERISH. CHERISH LIGHT.

PETEY
HELP MYSELF TO THIS GREAT WATER!

Petey drives the car away.

Emergency vehicles lights beat the morning Sun. The orchestra wails.

Liz rushes in with the DETECTIVE. She stops in her tracks, kneeling.

LIZZIE
LIFE IS A COMPLETE... DISASTER...
LIFE IS INCOMPLETE WITHOUT PETE-

DETECTIVE
WE ARE SORRY TO REPORT THE CAR SUBMERGED UNDER MACKINAC BRIDGE IS IDENTIFIED AS YOURS...

LIZZIE
AND...?

DETECTIVE
NO BODIES.
NOBODY.

The Detective hands the Petoskey necklace to Liz, then leaves.

LIZZIE
NOBODY LOVES ME LIKE THIS BODY OF WATER...

The Ghost of Petey manifests.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (V.O.)
NOBODY...

LIZZIE
WITH MY LAST TEAR, I'M OUT OF WATER IN MY HEART.

PETEY
YOU ARE MY SOUL.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (V.O.)
NOBODY...

Petey closes Liz's hand, sealing the Petoskey. Then, he vanishes.

End of "BODY OF WATER"

LIZZIE
Bridges are supposed to unite lands, not divide souls. Our house has been spared due to Petey's life insurance. But I didn't mind losing *what* is called home when it meant losing *who* I called home. I just wanna sink like a rock-

Shelby, bruised up, enters and embraces Liz on the ground.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
Every rock has a soft spot, like my son...

Liz places the Petoskey necklace down (now called the "Heirloom").

Shelby helps the grieving Liz exit.

[The real-life Andy Van Otteren's Memorial Poem written by his twin sister Sara may be included here, spoken or projected.]

END OF PROLOGUE

ACT I

SCENE 1

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE - AUGUST 2019 - DAY (11 YEARS LATER)

4. "YOOPERS AND TROLLS"

PETOSKEY (10, farm boy in a trapper hat) crawls out of his tent. He puts on the Heirloom and mittens. He bangs pots and pans.

LULU (10, city gal in a headscarf) crawls out of her tent and trolls.

LULU
...Petoskey!

PETOSKEY
Lulu!

LULU
Shut up, Yooper!

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
Pipe down, Troll!

Cherry, Perry, and Shelby enter.

CHERRY
Kids at it again?

SHELBY
With my daughter, you betcha.

PERRY
Let's be responsible... and place some bets.

SHELBY
Let's go Lulu! Your inheritance in on the line!

PETOSKEY
HOLY WAH! ANOTHER DAY TO GO FISHING!

LULU
YEAH NO... TODAY, WE GO BIRD WATCHING.

PETOSKEY
AREN'T YOU FROM EH... DEARBORN?

LULU
I AIN'T INTO DEER, YOU WILD YOOPERS...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
UNDER THE BRIDGE.
OVER THE MITTEN.
YOOPERS AND TROLLS.

PETOSKEY
EH, CRAZY TROLLS...
LET'S GO STARGAZING!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
WHAT ABOUT 'EM MOSQUITOES?

LULU
LET'S JUST WATCH WCMU-TV!

PETOSKEY
WLUC IS UP THERE!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
WOOD-TV 8 IS BETTER! (MOSQUITOES!)

LULU
I WILL BITE. I AM DOWN TO GO KAYAKING!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
UNDER THE BRIDGE.
OVER THE MITTEN!
PINE RIVER, THE FASTEST IN MICHIGAN!

Petoskey draws his water gun, but Lulu sprays him first.

PETOSKEY
ATTACK!

LULU
TOO SLOW!

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
I'VE GOT BACKUP!

Cousins JACOB JACOBOWITZ (adult actor), Twins LIBERTY and BAILEY, and the OTHERS open fire (water) and ambush Lulu before retreating.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
YOU WILL NEVER STAY DRY!
UNDER THE BRIDGE.
OVER THE MITTEN!

PETOSKEY
THANK YOU, COUSINS!

LULU
IT IS A SIN TO TARGET YOUR FAVORITE COUSIN.

Jacob hands a towel to Lulu. They hug before he exits. She dries up.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
(Repeating)
YOOPERS AND TROLLS.

LULU
HOLY CRAP, I HATE *HATE* CAMPING WITH YOU.

PETOSKEY
NO ONE LIKES YOUR HIP HOP TRASH.

LULU
TAKE IT BACK, COUNTRY BOY.

PETOSKEY
YOU FIRST, CITY GAL.

LULU & PETOSKEY
ANOTHER HARBOR DAYS...

LULU
...WITH THIS WILD YOOPER...

Lulu and Petoskey wrestle.

PETOSKEY
STAY UNDER THE BRIDGE, TROLL!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
YOOPERS AND TROLLS FORM A BRIDGE!

WILLY & MILLY
STOP FIGHTING!

End of "YOOPERS AND TROLLS"

LIZZIE
(Narrating)
Not a Harbor Days go by where my rock and his pearly cousin aren't fighting. The whole family's weird. There's cousin Jacob Jacobowitz who is making it on Broadway. Then Liberty and Bailey. Twin cousins from Hell... Michigan. My in-laws say they're angels.

Liberty and Bailey go buck wild and chase everyone around.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
I don't remember the other cousins Petoskey mentioned. They got many cousins, aunts, uncles- I wish I could meet them all but Mackinac. A bridge I cannot cross. Its watery depths crossed my heart and made many hope to die.

Cherry drives in. Petoskey sits. Then Perry takes over and gives him homework. Then Shelby and Lulu shove Perry and Petoskey out. Then Granny Milly respectfully takes over and lets him in the car.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
Fortunately, my son is able to. His aunties have no problem taking turns driving him from the U P to the L P. After Harbor Days, Granny Milly drives him home or insane. He is said to hear a man's voice whenever they cross-

As Petoskey naps in the car, he awakens to Petey's song.

PETEY (V.O.)
WAKEY WAKEY, SON...

Jasper takes over for Milly. He drops off Petoskey in Skandia. Liz sees Jasper become his godfather.

LIZZIE
Whenever Milly wasn't feeling well, Petoskey was Jasper's problem.

Then the real problem came in 2020. We didn't see it coming. Granny Milly, her genius mind, flawless cookies... suddenly gone. Grampy Willy canceled family reunions in 2020 to 2021. He needed to grieve alone. I worry for him and the Lake House. I'm thankful for our home, living off hubby's life insurance. But I cannot be sure Grampy Willy will be around much longer.

Petoskey looks at photos of Milly.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
Son, I know how much Grammy Milly meant to you. So, would it mean the world if I went to this year's Harbor Days? August two ol' two two.

PETOSKEY
You'd cross the bridge?

4A. "BODY OF WATER - REPRISE"

Darkness drowns Liz's light.

End of "BODY OF WATER - REPRISE"

LIZZIE
Nah. We'll take the long way through Wisconsin.

PETOSKEY
That's not fair! Everyone's cheesy there...

LIZZIE
Let's get a MOOoooove on. For Milly's sake.

Liz and Petoskey exit.

SCENE 2

INT. HOUSE - LIVING ROOM - AUGUST 2022 - DAY (3 YEARS LATER)

5. "IT WOULD BE A SHAME"

Willy stares longingly at a photo of his late wife Milly.

Amanda knocks on the door. Willy goes open it, then slams it.

AMANDA
I NEED YOUR LAKE HOUSE!

WILLY
YOU DAMN VULTURE.

MILLY (V.O.)
WHO ARE YOU CALLING A VULTURE?

Willy opens the door again. Amanda sets Milly's photo on her tablet.

AMANDA
AND YOU NEED YOUR WIFE BACK.
MY NAME'S AMANDA WAYLAND OF TURKEY VENTURES...
AND I CAN BRING YOUR WIFE TO LIFE!

WILLY
SHE DID NOT BELIEVE IN ALCHEMY.

AMANDA
THIS IS NOT ALCHEMY.
IT IS TECHNOLOGY!

Milly shows up behind Amanda.

MILLY
SO PROUD OF YOU.

AMANDA
(Raising the tablet volume)
YOU HEARD THAT?

MILLY
I LOVE YOU!!

AMANDA
I'D LOVE FOR YOU TO LET ME BUILD A DATA CENTER BY YOUR LAKE.
SO, SHE CAN GET THE WATER SHE NEEDS.

MILLY
DO NOT BRING SHAME.

Willy sees the Pit disapprove.

AMANDA
DON’T BE ASHAMED TO SAY “NO.”

WILLY
NO.

Milly disappears. Amanda “respects” his choice then nabs a photo. Outside, she sets it on her tablet. Petey enters the home.

PETEY
WASN’T MY LIFE WORTH MORE THAN MY HOUSE?

MILLY
IT’D BE A SHAME...

PETEY
WASN’T MY BREATH WORTH MORE THAN SOME LAKE?

MILLY
IT’D BE A SHAME...

PETEY
WASN’T MY HEART WORTH MORE THAN THESE ROCKS?

WILLY
THERE IS NO SHAME IN FORGETTING THEM.

Milly joins Petey.

PETEY, MILLY, AMANDA
SHAME...
SHAME...
ASHAMED...
ONLY SHAME...
NOTHING STAYS THE SAME...

WILLY
IT WOULD BE A SHAME IF I CHOSE THE HOUSE BEFORE MY FAMILY!
IT WOULD BE A SHAME IF I MAKE...

AMANDA
BRING BACK YOUR WIFE!

PETEY & MILLY
DON’T BE ASHAMED!

WILLY
IT’D BE A SHAME IF I MAKE THE...

PETEY & MILLY
THERE IS NO SHAME.

AMANDA
BRING BACK YOUR SON!

WILLY
IT'D BE A SHAME IF I MAKE THE SAME...

PETEY, MILLY, AMANDA
NOTHING STAYS THE SAME...

WILLY
IT'D BE SHAME IF I MAKE THE SAME MISTAKE...

AMANDA
IT'D BE A SHAME IF YOU MADE THE SAME...

PETEY, MILLY, AMANDA
IT'D BE A SHAME!

Milly and Petey vanish before Willy hugs them. Instead, he holds a tablet, displaying a contract.

End of "IT WOULD BE A SHAME"

SCENE 3

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE - DAY

6. "DAD TAX"

Jasper finishes setting up the tents for these useless Kids as Shelby and Liz stare in awe.

SHELBY
Thanks for everything, Jasper.

LULU
I really did not need your help.

PETOSKEY
You need all the help you can get, Lulu.

JASPER
And you needed manpower.

LULU
Ha! He called you a sissy, Petoskey!

LIZZIE
How could we ever repay you?

JASPER
Your sweetness is good 'nough for me.

Jasper nabs a handful of candy from Lulu and Petoskey's box.

LULU & PETOSKEY
That's *my* candy.

Lulu and Petoskey stare down one another as they fight for the box.

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
Mine! My sweets! Sugar! Mine!

LIZZIE
I'll let you take it from here.

Liz fist bumps Shelby and Cherry, then leaves the premises.

Jasper takes their box away.

JASPER
In the jurisdiction vested by the council of fathers and godfathers, everything is mine.

LULU & PETOSKEY
What jurisdiction?

Jasper pulls out the "Dad Rules!" book. They open it for the kids to skim, then they promptly close it.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
PAY UP!
PAY DOWN!
PAY UP!
PAY DOWN!

JASPER
YOU KIDS GOT NO SAY...

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
SO TAXATION WITHOUT REPRESENTATION?

JASPER
IT'S GOOD FOR THE COMMUNITY!

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
THAT'S WHAT A COMMUNIST WOULD SAY!

JASPER
JUST PAY YOUR FAIR SHARE!

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
NEVER!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
DAD RULES!
TAX SEASON!
CAMP REASONS!
COME COLLECT.
PAY DOWN YOUR DEBT.

Jasper and the Aunties collect.

AUNTIES (in unison)	LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS (as individuals)
YOUR COOKIES!	MY COOKIES!
YOUR CANDIES!	MY CANDY!
YOUR FRENCH FRIES!	MY FRENCH FRIES!
YOUR MILK SHAKES!	MY MILK SHAKE!
YOUR CHICKEN!	MY CHICKEN!
YOUR NUGGETS!	MY NUGGETS!
YOUR KID'S MEALS!	MY KID'S MEAL!
YOUR ROBLOX!	MY ROBLOX!
YOUR MINECRAFT!	MY MINECRAFT!
YOUR FREEDOM!	OUR CIVIL LIBERTIES!

JASPER
YOU'VE GOT TRANSPORTATION...
DRINKING WATER...

Jasper drinks the milk shakes.

JASPER (CONT'D)
THERE'RE NOW CAMP GOODS AND SERVICES...
ALL THANKS TO THE DAD TAX!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
PAY YOUR DAD TAX!

JASPER	LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
SUGAR CRASH!	ECONOMIC CRASH!

Jasper nervously hides, hearing Liz's footsteps. He can't breathe.

JASPER (CONT'D)
I need to collect dad tax because I owe...

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
Owe what???!!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
THE...

As peasant Jasper grovels, Queen Liz royally makes an entrance.

LIZZIE
MOM TAX! I'LL TAKE EVERYTHING!

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
EVERYTHING?!

JASPER
NOTHING'S OFF THE TABLE!

The Aunties remove a table.

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
EVEN THE TABLE?!

JASPER
NO ONE CAN STOP HER!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
NO ONE!

LIZZIE
NO ONE CAN STOP THE MOM TAX!

Liz starts a campfire using the wood from the table.

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
SHE'S ON FIRE!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
SHE'LL TAKE ANYTHING!

LIZZIE
CASH *AND* CREDIT!

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
EVERYTHING'S
OURS OURS OURS OURS.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
OURS OURS
OURS OURS.

[melancholic bridge where Petoskey wants a dad who dad-taxes him and Liz misses her Petey to mom-tax.]

Liz and the Aunties down insane amounts of candy. Their focus suddenly shifts to the Audience. They prepare to pounce.

JASPER
OH NO, Y'ALL COOKED.

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
OH NO, WE'RE COOKED.

Lulu retreats into her tent.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
THE...

LIZZIE
THEATRE TAX!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
...THEATRE TAX!

Liz and the Aunties run into the Audience and tax them for everything and anything!

JASPER
TAX THE AUDIENCES!

PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
NOT THE AUDIENCES!

LIZZIE
ATTENTION!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
WE'LL TAKE EVERYONE!

LIZZIE
GIVE ME YOUR TIX! TIX! TIX! TIX!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
OURS OURS OURS OURS...

JASPER
EVERYTHING'S...

JASPER (CONT'D)
(Repeating)
TAX! TAX! TAX! TAX!

LIZZIE
(Repeating)
TIX! TIX! TIX! TIX!

PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
(Repeating)
MOM?! MOM?! MOM?! MOM?!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
(Repeating)
OURS OURS OURS OURS!

LIZZIE
SUGAR CRASH...

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
ECONOMIC CRASH...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
MINE! MINE! MINE! MINE! MINE!

JASPER
SHE'LL TAKE ALL, ESPECIALLY TIME!

LIZZIE
I'VE COME TO COLLECT YOUR DAD TAX!

PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
NO TAXATION WITHOUT REPRESENTATION!

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
LET'S TAKE EVERYTHING!

Liz and the Aunties down the rest of the candy! (⊙‿◎)

End of "DAD TAX"

They gather by the campfire.

JASPER
A perfect campfire to honor Grammy Milly, all on the taxpayers' expense. Lemme go get Grampy Willy.

Jasper goes into the Lake House while Shelby goes to Lulu's tent.

SHELBY
Lemme get Lulu... Dearest Lulu, everyone's waiting for you.

LULU
Where?

SHELBY
By the bonfire.

LULU
That can wait. I've got a musical to finish!

SHELBY
And you think staying in tents like your room fills you with inspiration?

LULU
I need to finish my musical before school starts at the end of the month.

SHELBY
You can't write on empty eyes.

LULU
Don't you mean stomach?

SHELBY
You can't write without *fire in your eyes*.

7. "DEARBORN"

The Flutist plays beautifully.

LULU
Not quite my sound...

The Banjo replaces the Flutist.

LULU (CONT'D)
That's more like it! *Fire~*
OOO... OOO... OOO... OOO... OOO...
DEAREST LULU!
DEARBORN REPRESENT!

I DON'T KNOW WHY TIME
HAS NEVER MOVED FORWARD
EV' SINCE I WAS BORN
EV' SINCE I COULD RHYME!
I CANNOT FIND THAT STATE OF MIND.
SIGH...
SO HELP ME,
MY DEAREST.

LULU (CONT'D)
I HAVE BEEN IN TUNE
TO EARTH AND HER SPIRITS
THE DAY MOM GAVE BIRTH
'TIL I'M A TOMB.
BURY MY HEART, SO SHE'D BLOOM.
OOO... OOO... RAISE ME.
OH DEAREST.
DEARBORN.

The Van Otterloos point to Dearborn on their hands.

Lulu shows off her theatre fandom.

LULU (CONT'D)
I HAVE DREAMT COUNTLESS FABLES SET TO MUSICALS!
HOW OH HOW CAN I NOT WRITE PAST "DEAR?"
MY LYRICS LACK SOUL, LOSING HER SENSE OF DIRECTION.
SPIRITUAL CONNECTIONS.
DEAR ME: WHY CAN'T I LOCK IN?
DEARBORN WRITER'S BLOCK!

In Lulu's mind, the rest of the Van Otterloos answer her question. They form Ls with their hands.

VAN OTTERLOOS
DEAR LULU,
YOU'RE A LOSAH!
A LOONEY LOSER!

LULU
NOTE TO SELF: IT'S BECAUSE
YOUR FAMILY HATES YOU, LU...

VAN OTTERLOOS (CONT'D)
LOO... LOO...
LOSER...

Lulu runs away. Then, she stops in the middle of a dirt road.

LULU (CONT'D)
NO LONGER IN TUNE
TO EARTH AND HIS DEMONS.
I WISH MOM AIN'T BIRTH ME.
SEE YOU IN A TOMB.
BURY MY HEART FOR SHE'S DOOMED.
OOO... DON'T SAVE ME.
DON'T DEARY...

A car's headlights approaches. Before it can hit her, a DEER stands in its way and stops it.

LULU (CONT'D)
Ah deer...

A herd of Deer join in.

LULU (CONT'D)
Oh deers!

DEER
The plural form is still "deer," dear.

DEER (CONT'D)
Why are you in the middle of the road?

LULU
My life's a dead end. Why are you protecting me, deer...ssss...?

DEER
Who exactly are we protecting?

LULU
A Middle Eastern girl in the middle of a Midwestern world...
NAME'S LULU...

LULU (CONT'D) DEER
I'M A LOSER. A LOOSE CANNON
A LOONEY LOSER. HUH? WITH NOTHING TO LOSE.

DEER (CONT'D)
DEARBORN.
YOU'RE MEANT TO GO BUCK WILD!
BUT WERE MADE SHY.
WHY OH WHY AIN'T YA BORN A
DEER FACING SPOTLIGHT, BENT, AGILE, A RESPECTABLE ROLE.
MOTHER NATURE'S SOULS.

LULU
OOO... OOO... OOO...
DEAR ME: NOW I WANNA START WRITING MUSICALS ABOUT DEER?

The Deer lead Lulu back to the bonfire.

DEER
DEARY... OOO...
DEAREST LULU,
PLEASE CHOOSE YOUR MUSE, SPIRIT, LU...
DON'T LOSE TO THESE LOSERS.
GOT THAT, LULU?
LULU?

LULU
I WANNA WIN EVERYONE'S HEARTS WITH OR WITHOUT MY ART!
CAN AH CAN I MAKE MY "I WANT" SONG CLEARER?

LULU (CONT'D)
I WANNA WIN RESPECT BY ANY MEANS!
EVENING GETTING MEAN!

DEAR ME:
WHAT WILL I BRING BEING DEARBORN DEARBORN!

The Van Otterloos gather, not knowing a herd lurks nearby.

LULU (CONT'D)
DEAR LULU... YES, YOU!
YOU YOU YOU YOU YOU. YOU'RE...
DEARBORN. DEARBORN. YOU ARE DEAREST BORN...

VAN OTTERLOOS
DEAR LULU,
YOU'RE A LOSAH!
A LOONEY LOSER!
LOO... LOO...
LOSER...

DEER
DEAREST LULU,
THE LOOSE CANNON WITH NOTHING TO LOSE.
LULU... LULU... LULU...

The fire rises, scaring off the herd of Deer.

End of "DEARBORN"

LIBERTY & BAILEY
So some deers saved you when you ran off?

LULU
Plural of "deer" is still "deer." Yes, dear.

PETOSKEY
Lulu, you are a looooossseeeerrrr.

Lulu lowers her banjo in defeat.

JACOB
Shut it, Petoskey! *Loser*- I mean- *Lulu* gets to pick la pizzzzaaa. I'll order, but remember: nothing beats New York piz-

PERRY & SHELBY
We get it, you live in New York-

CHERRY
And you're everyone's favorite cousin. Son of the best auntie. Pick wisely, child.

LULU
Jet's!

JACOB
Sharks! But uh seriously something edible.

LULU
Little Caesars!

JACOB
Et tu, Lulu?

CHERRY
Shelby, your daughter has good tastes.

LULU
Domino's...?

LIBERTY & BAILEY
We ain't falling for Domino's.

BAILEY
Let's go with Biggby!

LIBERTY
Ain't Biggby coffee?

JACOB
Shush your big mouths! Biggby is overrated. I'd rather get coffee at Great Lakes Ace Hardware.

LULU
So hard to please... Hungry Howie's?

JACOB
Let's go with Cottage Inn. *It's so in.*

SHELBY
I wish there was a Buddy's Pizza in Traverse.

CHERRY
Nothing beats a Family Fare-brand pizza.

PERRY
It's got nothing on Meijer!

Jasper enters with Willy. He pulls up a chair and out a Banh Mi pizza. Yes, the Vietnamese writer of this musical is making a mockery out of Banh MI. *Xin loi.*

WILLY
I've lived this long as my diet consists of Jasper Vinh Chin's Banh Mi pizza. I eat it everyday. Breakfast, lunch, and dinner.

JASPER
With dad tax comes universal basic pizza. *Cam on, ông Willy (Viet: "Thank you, Willy").*

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
Come on. What took you hours?

JASPER
Willy kept chatting it up with the ghost of Henry Ford.

WILLY
He said the Ford Model T needed an oil change.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
That Ford, ugh...

Willy sits. Everyone sits down.

CHERRY
We gather here today to remember Grammy Milly. It’s been a couple years since she left this world...

WILLY
Actually, Milly came back a couple days ago.

Everyone stares at Willy like an old man who lost his marbles.

PERRY
In what world?

SHELBY
It’s time to put you in a nursing home.

Willy pulls out a tablet.

WILLY
Home is in here.

CHERRY
Dad, you can’t just call the afterlife.

WILLY
Milly, please call.

Milly appears on the tablet, disturbing everyone.

MILLY
Willy... Even from the Great Beyond, I’m way ahead of you.

LULU, PETOSKEY, KIDS
She looks so real!

WILLY
She is.

PERRY
No, she’s not.

CHERRY
She... Don’t break dad’s heart again.

WILLY
You all have seen enough of your mama. I can ask Petey to call.

Liz covers Petoskey’s eyes.

LIZZIE
No no no.

JASPER
What did this cost?

WILLY
It doesn’t matter.

CHERRY
How much?

WILLY
My son was worth more than...

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
...the house...?!

Amanda slyly steps in.

AMANDA
It’d be a shame for another father figure to dishonor the Van Otterloos once more by picking the house over their own family’s wellbeing. Yes, access to Afterlife dot AI was on the house. I see it’s a perfect time to come in when everyone seems fired up. Cherry.

CHERRY
Amanda...

AMANDA
How’s making ‘em kiddy costumes for your dumb Harbor Days parade?

CHERRY
How’s making anything? That’s right. You can’t.

LULU
Who’s she?

PERRY
Amanda Wayland was Cherry’s classmate in Hope College art school.

CHERRY
Until she was caught cheating with *Photoshop*.

AMANDA
And now everyone's using Photoshop. By the way, I did complete my engineering degree at U of M.

VAN OTTERLOOS
Ew... The Wolverines.

LULU, PETOSKEY, JACOB, TWINS
Rabies...

AMANDA
Bite me. Now, everyone around the world depends on me to get through the day, answer questions smart or dumb, read novels, write essays... *entire musicals-*

LULU & JACOB
You Sweeney Todd-ed monster!

Lulu and Jacob is just about ready to slit this crony's throat.

AMANDA
I didn't get to the best part. It does the impossible. It brings the dead to life.

CHERRY
Get out.

AMANDA
You're impressed.

PERRY
Depressed. Seriously, get out.

SHELBY
Vamos!

JASPER
Willy, implore this morally ambiguous woman to leave the premises.

AMANDA
The premise is... I own your Lake House. There's a Willy, there's a way. Willy, thanks for not making the same mistake your son made.

CHERRY
To maintain the premises...

8. “AI DOES THE WORK FOR ME”

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
Who will do the hard work?

Amanda releases AI slop.

AMANDA
A I!!!

VAN OTTERLOOS
A I? R U CRAZY!

AMANDA
LISTEN, FREAKS.
I’M NOT YOUR ENEMY!

DON’T MISS THIS GREAT OPPORTUNITY!

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O CHERRY
IT’S FREE?

AMANDA
SO FREE.

CHERRY
THIS IS SLAVERY.

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O CHERRY
REALLY?

AMANDA
BUT DIRT CHEAP!

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O CHERRY
LET’S CHEAT!

CHERRY
THE BILL FOR ELECTRICITY?

AMANDA
SPEAKING OF CITY!
EVERY CITY WITH A DATA CENTER HAS INTERNET FASTER THAN LIGHT!

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O CHERRY
LIGHT?!

AMANDA
EVERY HOSPITAL RUN BY DATA CENTERS SENDS PATIENTS AWAY FROM THE LIGHT.

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O CHERRY
LIGHT?

AMANDA
ANY ORDINARY JOE WILL CENTER DATA FROM GOD’S ENLIGHTENMENT.

VAN OTTERLOOS
LIGHT.

LIBERTY & BAILEY
CAN DATA CENTERS MAKE MEMES?!

AMANDA
AI'S DOING THE WORK WITH MEMES!
YOU'D GET COMEDY LETTING IT MAKE MEMES OF YOUR FAMILY!

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O CHERRY
WHAT ABOUT MONEY?

AMANDA
OH, AI'S DOING THE WORK FOR FREE!
YOU'LL GROW WEALTHY LETTING IT DAY TRADE IN YOUR CRYPTOCURRENCIES!

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O CHERRY
WILL IT GROW A CONSCIENCE?

AMANDA
AI WILL UNDERSTAND CONSCIOUSNESS...

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O CHERRY
MEMES?

AMANDA
...FOR US!

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O CHERRY
MONEY?

AMANDA
FOR ME...

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O CHERRY
CONSCIENCE?

Amanda shows a 1984-esque digital photo of her late brother Conor.

AMANDA
FOR MY CONOR!

CHERRY
YOUR BROTHER?

VAN OTTERLOOS
BIG BROTHER...

AMANDA
AI'S DOING THE WORK FOR ME!
I'LL MAKE HISTORY WITH DATA CENTERS IN ALL CITIES!
AI MAY GROW A CONSCIENCE BEFORE ANYONE OF US WILL REALIZE...
OH WELL...

AI'S GONNA MAKE ME LOTSA MONEY!
THAT'S THE MYSTERY OF DATA CENTERS IN YOUR CITIES!

MAYBE I WILL GROW A CONSCIENCE BEFORE ANYONE OF YOU SPREAD LIES...
NO WAY...
AI DOES THE WORK FOR ME!

End of "AI DOES THE WORK FOR ME"

PETOSKEY
Wow... Yas, Kween!

Jacob slaps Petoskey's shoulder.

JACOB
Don't say "Kween" in a straight way ever again.

AMANDA
As your "Kween," I am entitled to a tour of your shanty palace.

Cherry is about to lead Amanda.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
No no no. I only give access to those who showed some respect around here. Crystal?

PETOSKEY
Petoskey.

AMANDA
Okay. Pebble.

PETOSKEY
May I bring my mom?

Petoskey and Liz lead Amanda into the Lake House.

SCENE 4

INT. ELK LAKE HOUSE - EVENING

The walls are full of photos.

Petoskey and Liz guide Amanda around the Lake House.

AMANDA
My guys will help preserve these photos. Don't you worry about it.

LIZZIE
You'll give them back, right?

AMANDA
No. And the digital prints will be behind a paywall.

PETOSKEY
What's a paywall?

LIZZIE
It's the reason so many people in this state get their news from online conspiracy theorists instead of reading Detroit *Free* Press or MLive.

8A. "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE"

AMANDA
What's that?

LIZZIE
I thought you're the know-all of capitalism.

Amanda points at a photo of young Petoskey wearing the Heirloom.

AMANDA
No... That.

LIZZIE
It's my late husband's Heirloom.

PETOSKEY
It's what I'm named after.

Amanda sees shadows of her and her late brother playing with rocks.

AMANDA
You outgrew it? Well, no one outgrows cool rocks, especially a Petoskey. This one seems like it's worth a whole Great Lake. No... It's an heirloom. Your dead husband makes this worth two Great Lakes. Unlike him, is it here?

PETOSKEY
Grammy Milly gave it to me. It's her last gift.

AMANDA
How about a trade?

PETOSKEY
The house...

AMANDA
...for your cool rock. Well, produce it.

PETOSKEY
I wanna put on a show. I need a whole day.

AMANDA
After the Grande Parade?

LIZZIE
After the Grande Parade.

AMANDA
Life will be complete with this cool rock.

Amanda departs.

LIZZIE
And the Lake House back to Grampy Willy.

End of "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE"

PETOSKEY
The Heirloom is at the bottom of Pine River...

LIZZIE
You said you let Lulu borrow it? Wait, when did you go to Pine River? The fastest rapids in the state! It's dangerous and forbidden! Only Petey and I- Some have canoed there, like Jacob when he was Cherry's teenager...

PETOSKEY
Well three years ago, Jacob took us on a little detour...

SCENE 5

EXT. LUMBERJACK PARK - AUGUST 2019 - DAY (3 YEARS AGO)

9. "WILD MIDWEST"

Jacob paces like a sergeant as his Cousins stand in formation.

JACOB
You all are not supposed to be here, but here we are now. All thanks to?

COUSINS
Our favorite cousin Jacob...

JACOB
Favorite?

COUSINS
The famous actor Jacob Jacobowitz...

JACOB
These rapids are not an act. Uncle Petey used to take us canoeing. So blessed to keep this tradition alive. So, shhhhh. Tell your parents and ya dead meat.

LIBERTY & BAILEY
It’s not the rapids that’ll kill you.

BAILEY
It’s the pine!

LIBERTY
Or the sand!

JACOB
You two will be the death of me...

Anywho, each canoe needs two rowers. I’ll pair you all by ages. Liberty, Bailey, no clue how old y’all are. Lulu, Petoskey, you’re both ten-

Jacob pairs up each cousins.

Lulu mockingly sticks her tongue out at Petoskey.

Each team carry in their canoe.

Jacob hands out the paddles.

JACOB (CONT’D)
Here are your paddles. Now each duo must decide their bow and stern.

LULU
Isn’t the stern lotsa work?

JACOB
Affirmative.

LULU & PETOSKEY
I choose the bow! No, you’re stern! You lazy good for nothin’-

LULU
Whoever gets soaked first...

PETOSKEY
...has to row these rapids...

JACOB
We’ve got ourselves a WILD MIDWEST SHOWDOWN!

Lulu and Petoskey walk in opposite directions before turning to face each other. They prepare to draw their water guns.

The Twins leap out and startle Lulu. She sprays them while Petoskey unloads on her.

Lulu lies on the ground, defeated.

PETOSKEY
Get paddling! What? I promised the twins from Hell I'd cover their dad tax for the rest of Harbor Days.

LULU
You're gonna sink, Petoskey...

End of "WILD MIDWEST"

They all lower the canoes into Pine River and get on. On a kayak, Jacob leads the canoes downstream.

JACOB
Our first rapids is dead ahead! Make sure you don't stick the paddles in the sharp rocks.

Lulu sticks a paddle in Petoskey.

LULU
Ya ain't sharp, Petoskey.

PETOSKEY
Forget the water guns. You're getting waterboarded, Lulu.

LULU
Woah! That's messed up, war-crimes boy!

The group brushes past the rapids easily. A pine tree overhead brushes against Bailey.

BAILEY
Ah! Ah! Pineee!!!

Bailey collapses in the canoe.

LIBERTY
Twin down! Twin down! We gotta ground!

JACOB
What?! What is it?!

As the canoe stops, Liberty touches the sandy ground.

LIBERTY
Ah! Ah! Sanddd!!!

Liberty convulses by the dune.

Jacob docks and tends to Liberty.

JACOB
You didn't tell us you're really allergic to uh-

LIBERTY
Sand!

BAILEY
Pine!

JACOB
Pine?! Sand?! That's basically Michigan!

JACOB (CONT'D)
Lulu, Petoskey, you go on ahead.

Liberty and Bailey go dead.

JACOB (CONT'D)
(Crying)
Kill two birds with pine and sand. Stop playing dead!

The Twins sit up spontaneously, holding up poison ivy bouquets.

LIBERTY & BAILEY
Poison ivy bouquets?

JACOB
Oh Goddd!!!

LIBERTY & BAILEY
The twins from Hell strike again!

Jacob itches his face to no ends. He runs off as the Twins and other Cousins follow him out.

Lulu and Petoskey separate from the group.

LULU
There is fishiness afoot.

A parent or a couple with their child or children walk along the river with their fishing gears.

Petoskey looks longingly at them.

Fishes swim by in the river.

10. "FISH FOR MOM AND DAD"

LULU
IF YOU CAN CATCH...

PETOSKEY
AND RELEASE...

LULU
ANYTHING...

PETOSKEY
IN THE WORLD?

Lulu grabs a fishing hook from out of nowhere and holds it up to Petoskey.

LULU
I'M GONNA HOOK YOUR MOUTH IF YOU KEEP INTERRUPTING ME.
WHAT WOULD THEY BE?

PETOSKEY
WHO COULD THEY BE?

Lulu grabs a Bass from the river.

LULU
ARE YOU FISHING FOR THE ANSWER?

BASS
LET'S FISH FOR AN ANSWER.

LULU
Dang! This fish has range!

PETOSKEY
Drop the bass!

Lulu drops the Bass. The Bassist puts on a fish mask. The fishes leap out and lay down the beat on the surface tension of the river.

FISHES
I WANNA GO CAMPING!
I WANNA GO HUNTING!
I WANNA GO FISHING!
YOU NEED A CAMP BUDDY.
YOU NEED A HUNTING MENTOR.

Lulu tunes her banjo.

2008 Liz and Petey canoe besides 2019 Lulu and Petoskey. Liz is the bow while Petey is the stern.

FISHES (CONT'D)
YOU NEED TO CATCH...
AND RELEASE...
YOU NEED TO CATCH...
AND RELEASE...
YOU NEED TO CATCH...
AND RELEASE...

PETOSKEY
MY FATHER'S SOUL.
MY MOTHER'S WOES.
MAMA BEING CAREFREE.
PAPA BEING WITTY.
MOM AS A NEWLY WED.
DAD FROM HIS DEATHBED.

Lulu and the Fishes pause, looking surprised.

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
I SAID WHAT I SAID.

The rest of the Cousins catch up to Lulu and Petoskey. Poison ivy covers Jacob's body. They perform a fatherly and woodcraft dance.

Petoskey gets his fishing pole and extends it to Petey's canoe.

Petey accepts Petoskey's fishing pole and reels himself in.

LULU & COUSINS
YOU WANNA GO CAMPING?

FISHES
I WANNA GO CAMPING!

PETOSKEY
WITH MY DAD!

LULU & COUSINS
YOU WANNA GO HUNTING?

FISHES
I WANNA GO HUNTING!

PETOSKEY
WITH MY DAD!

LULU & COUSINS
YOU WANNA GO FISHING?

FISHES
I WANNA GO FISHING!

PETOSKEY
WITH MY DAD!

LULU & COUSINS
I'LL BE YOUR CAMP BUDDY!

FISHES
YOU NEED A CAMP BUDDY.

PETOSKEY
ALL I NEED IS MY DAD.

LULU & COUSINS
I'LL TRY HUNTING, I GUESS.

FISHES
YOU NEED A HUNTING MENTOR.

PETOSKEY
ALL I WANT IS A DAD.

LULU & COUSINS
THERE IS A CATCH...

FISHES
YOU NEED TO CATCH...

Petoskey holds up the Heirloom for Petey and Liz to bear witness.

PETOSKEY
MY FATHER'S SOUL!

LULU & COUSINS FISHES
AND RELEASE! AND RELEASE!

End of "FISH FOR MOM AND DAD"

Everyone approaches the rapids.

PETEY
WAKEY, WAKEY, SON...

LULU
Wake up, dumdum! We're heading towards the last rapids-

Lulu hits Petoskey with the paddle which causes the canoe to capsize.

Underwater, Petoskey loses grip of Petey, now gone. He realizes the Heirloom is missing from his neck.

SCENE 6

EXT. PINE RIVER - AUGUST 2022 - DAY (PRESENT)

Present-day Liz grabs Petoskey from the water.

LIZZIE
Found your rock, yet?

PETOSKEY
I swear dad was here. I mean *the Petoskey*.

LIZZIE
Liberty, Bailey, getting warmer?

BAILEY
(Smirking)
The water is warmer here...

LIBERTY
Ew...

PETOSKEY
Those two are seriously from Hell.

LIZZIE
They're sweet angels for tagging along to help you find a necklace you lost three years ago...

PETOSKEY
I promised they can pick my costume for next year if they found it.

LIZZIE
What do they want you to wear?

PETOSKEY
Welp, I'd be lucky if I wear clothes.

Lulu shows up.

LULU
Mom told me I should help...

PETOSKEY
Wanna help me lose something else?

LULU
Nah, bruh. I'm deciding what you'll wear next Harbor Days! The Sun is directly above us. It won't be dark until...

The Sun falls out of the sky. The Moon instantly replaces her.

A bonfire lives by Lulu, Petoskey, and the rest of the Van Otterloos.

LULU (CONT'D)
No time...

PETOSKEY
No rocks... No father... No sorrys...

They all get some rest.

10A. "DEARBORN - REPRISE"

While in her sleeping bag, Lulu sees a Deer pass by.

LULU
(Quietly)
DEAR LULU,
YOU'RE NO LOSER!
A ROCKY LOSER!
YOU'LL... FIND...
PETOSKEY...

Lulu dozes off.

End of "DEARBORN - REPRISE"

SCENE 7

EXT. LAKE MICHIGAN SHORES - MORNING

11. “TIME DOES HEAL”

Perry make some noise to wake up Lulu, Petoskey, and the other Cousins. She pulls them to the shore for a quick science lesson.

PERRY
SCIENCE NEVER ENDS!

COUSINS
SCIENCE NEVER ENDS!

PERRY
SCIENCE IS YOUR BEST FRIEND!

COUSINS
SCIENCE IS OUR BEST FRIEND!

Perry pulls out a Fossil and goes to the Audience.

PERRY
CAN ANYONE TELL ME WHAT THIS IS?
CAN YOU TELL ME WHAT THIS IS?
WHAT IS IT?
THAT’S RIGHT, A FOSSIL!

YOU KNOW WHAT THEY SAY?!

COUSINS
WHAT?!

PERRY
FOSSILS ARE HERE TO STAY!

FOSSILS ARE NATURE’S TIME CAPSULE.

COUSINS
HOW MANY YEARS?

PERRY
THOUSANDS, MILLIONS OF YEARS!

COUSINS
A LONG TIME!

PERRY
FOSSILS ARE NATURE’S FIRST LESSON.

COUSINS
WHAT DO THEY TEACH?

PERRY
THAT TIME DOES HEAL.

COUSINS
HEAL.

PERRY & COUSINS
WE'LL ALL LEARN TO HEAL.

LULU
DO FOSSILS HAVE FEELINGS?

PERRY
FOSSILS DO HOLD MEMORIES.

COUSINS
WHAT DO THEY REMEMBER?

PERRY
BODY, DIET, HISTORY.

PERRY & COUSINS
FOSSILS HAVE A STORY TO SHARE.

PERRY
STARE AT IT LONG AND YOU WILL SEE.
FOSSILS HAVE ALL SORTS OF HISTORY.

PETOSKEY
DON'T FOSSILS REMIND US WE'LL BE HISTORY?

PERRY
I KNOW HOW YOU FEEL...
FOSSILS COME HERE TO HEAL
BECAUSE...

PERRY & COUSINS
FOSSILS ARE HERE TO STAY!

PERRY
FOSSILS ARE SPLIT INTO TWO MAIN GROUPS!

The Cousins hold up dinosaur bones and footprints.

COUSINS
TRACE AND BODY!

PERRY
FOOTPRINT FOSSILS ARE DIFFERENT FROM BONES!

COUSINS
DINOSAURS!

PERRY
FOSSILS ARE NATURE'S REMINDER!

COUSINS
AND THAT IS TIME...

PERRY
THAT TIME DOES HEAL.

COUSINS
HEAL.

PERRY & COUSINS
WE'LL ALL LEARN TO HEAL.
FOSSILS HELP US HEAL.

Perry gives fossils to everyone.

End of "TIME DOES HEAL"

12. "GICHIGAMIIN (THE GREAT LAKES BALLET)"

Lulu trails off from the group, looking at her fossil. As she walks along the coastline of the fourth wall, the Deer approaches from the Audience. They startle her. She uses the fossil as a shield. The Deer snatches her fossil away then drop off the Heirloom and other special rocks. She stares at the rock deposit.

MAGTOGOEK (THE WALKING PATH)

First, Lulu feels a glacial rock. The history of the Great Lakes courses through her. She floats from the Atlantic Ocean into the mainland on St. Lawrence River.

ONIATARÍ:IO (THE LAKE OF SHINING WATERS)

The Chippewa, Keepers of Tradition, dance and interact.

ERIELHONAN (LONG TAIL)

The Ottawa, Keepers of the Trade, dance and interact.

KAREGNONDI (LAKE)

The Potawatomi, Keepers of the Fire, dance and interact.

MICHIGAMI (GREAT WATER)

The Anishinaabe, Council of Three Fires, come together and dance and interact.

ᑭᖃᒻ (GREAT SEA)

Lulu touches the Heirloom. Pain strikes her.

17TH-CENTURY FRENCH EXPLORERS, FUR TRADERS, and MISSIONARIES set foot on the shore. They terrorize and scare off the Anishinaabe. One colonizer resembles Petey. He pulls out a sword and prepares to strike down Lulu.

Present-day Shelby intervenes. The Explorers vanish into the unknown.

End of "GICHIGAMIIN (THE GREAT LAKES BALLET)"

Shelby helps Lulu up.

SHELBY
Ready to go to the parade? Woah, those are some neat-o rocks. Did you go swimming in Lake Michigan? You don't seem all that soaked.

LULU
I dried up super quick-

SHELBY
You scrapped your arm. Don't play with rocks, dear.

LULU
It more so messed with my head. The rocks played with me. For the parade, I've got a perfect costume for this problem. A cast.

Lulu gathers the rocks. She holds the Petoskey with resentment. They exit.

SCENE 8

EXT. YPSILANTI CITY HALL - MORNING

Residents stand in line to speak before Amanda and the Council.

RESIDENTS
Ypsilanti does not need a data center!

RESIDENT
My folks in Saline can't sleep with all your humming! We ain't losing it over a data center!

RESIDENT (CONT'D)
Born and raised in Flint. We still don't have clean water. *Thanks Rick*. No data centers!

RESIDENT (CONT'D)
Can we rename Ypsilanti Yoopsilanti?

RESIDENTS
No!

RESIDENT
My cows are so stressed, they are birthing stillborn calves. We've got no beef with you.

AMANDA
Nor do I.

RESIDENT
You heard me wrong. We've got no beef, thanks to you. Your data center is gonna starve us.

AMANDA
Data centers would end world hunger!

RESIDENTS
That's rich, coming from you! Do you even know what hunger feels like?

13. "THE STARVING ARTIST"

Amanda leaves and returns as an avant-garde artist, with the Bob Ross spirit.

AMANDA
I AM HUNGRY TO SEE HOW THIS WORLD WORKED.
HUNGRY TO EXPRESS MY HUMANITARIAN WORK!
I WAS FEEDING ART TO THE COMMUNITY,
FREEING THOSE WHO HAVE TRAPPED THEIR HUMANITY!
AND I AIN'T DONE THIS ALONE.

CONOR, Amanda's brother, appears as a silhouette or avatar or other subjective ways.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
WE WERE HUNGRY, MY BROTHER AND I, STARVED!
EATING TIME FOR ART BEFORE FEEDING OUR OWN BELLIES!
WE'VE HAD HOPES AND DREAMS TO BRING CLEAN WATER-
PAINT WITH NO PAIN.

Amanda strikes ~~paint~~.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
I HOPE THAT MY DREAM PAINTS YOU A PICTURE.

Amanda and Conor graduate top of their class of 2006 in computer engineering at the University of Michigan. She goes to art school at Hope College while Conor starts the tech startup, Turkey Ventures.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
WE ONCE STARTED WITH NOTHING BUT FIRE IN OUR EYES.
BLOOD, SWEAT, TEARS, BUT NO FEARS.
BLOOD, SWEAT, TEARS, LET'S NOT FEAR.
HOPE, LOVE, PRAYERS, PLEASE DON'T FEAR.

Conor paves the way for AI art.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
I WAS SKEPTICAL
ABOUT WHAT'S LOGICAL
ABOUT HIS AI.
MY BIG BROTHER WATCHED AS ARTISTS STARVED AND HE WANTED TO CHANGE THAT.
HE NEEDED TO CHANGE ARTISTIC PATIENCE.
SO NO ONE EVER DIES FOR NOTHING.
HE SACRIFICED EVERYTHING.

Conor loses his lifework during the 2007 recession.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
I NOW KNOW THAT THERE'S NOTHING TO SHOW FROM MY HEART.
BLOOD, SWEAT, TEAR'S HERE TO...

FEAR NOT, I KNOW WHAT IT'S LIKE TO STARVE.
I WAS A STARVING ARTIST.

Cherry comes across Amanda. Cherry is about to greet her classmate, until she shows off her tech. With great disappointment, Cherry dismisses Amanda. Amanda soon gets expelled from art school.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
TECHNOLOGY AND I SHALL NOT
LET ANYONE END UP A STARVING ARTIST.
TRUST ME, YOU WON'T END UP LIKE MY BROTHER.
BLOOD, SWEAT, TEARS 'TIL HE DIED.

I'VE HELD BLOOD, SWEAT, TEARS 'TIL HIS SUICIDE.

Amanda sees Cherry grieve, after her own brother Petey's suicide. This time, Amanda dismisses Cherry and takes over Turkey Ventures in honor of Conor.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
WATER TOOK EVERYTHING FROM ME...

Amanda's artistic spirit washes away, becoming the businessperson she is now.

AMANDA (CONT'D)
I'LL TAKE WATER AWAY FROM EVERYONE!
MY CREATIVE SPIRIT BLED, SWEAT, TORE WHEN HE DIED...
I LOVE HIM AS THE STARVING ARTIST.

The Residents become content. The Council approves the data center.

Amanda gets out a map of Michigan. Many cities and towns are checked off. She checks off Ypsilanti. She points to Elk Rapids.

End of "THE STARVING ARTIST"

SCENE 9

EXT. ELK RAPIDS - NOON

The Grande Parade is underway. As Jacob is this year's Grand Marshall, the theme is Musical Theatre. The Van Otterloos adjust their costumes and makeup.

Lulu wears an Evan Hansen cast.

Petoskey adjusts his suspenders.

LULU
Who are you supposed to be, Petoskey?

PETOSKEY
Um... Jud- Uh?

LULU
Oh! Jud Fry. That guy suuuuccckkkkssss. He thinks it is *O K* to beat up women.

PETOSKEY
Are you supposed to be Tiny um Tim um Timmy?

Lulu waves at a window.

LULU
Waving through a window?

PETOSKEY
So, my guy sucks. And your guy's creepy.

The Twins dress up as Elphaba and Glinda.

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
And those two are like- princess witches?

The Twins monkey around.

LULU
Nah, they're flying monkeys! *They're Elphaba and Glinda*. This is Musical Theatre 101.

PETOSKEY
I hate musicals.

Lulu approaches Jacob, who is dressed as Wednesday from *The Addams Family*.

LULU
Wednesday, Jud Fry is against everything you stand for.

JACOB
At least I get to stand at the end, unlike Jud Fry. By the way, isn't this inspiring you?

A bell rings in the distance.

Jacob heads to his post.

PETOSKEY
How's that musical you're writing?

Lulu pulls out a giant scrapbook with deer stickers.

LULU
Dearborn the musical! It'll have its showcase at my middle school fall talent show! Emma's gonna play Mama Deer, Lukas is Papa Deer, Camille is Cathy Dee- Oh! And Dionne's uh Lake Superior, Lee's gonna be Huron-

Petoskey grows bored and walks away.

LULU (CONT'D)
Where ya goin'?! Eh, I'll have you singing like a canary in front of the family in due time.

CHERRY
(Whistling)
This is the parade you all've been waiting for. You'd expect I can give a pep talk, being married to a sport guy, but he's a hockey guy.
(MORE)

CHERRY (CONT'D)
They don't talk, they beat each other up. Anyone got some positive news they'd like to share before we proceed?

SHELBY
We've got a new winner for this year's rock collection.

Shelby steps aside to show Lulu and her rocks in all her glory.

LIBERTY & BAILEY
Wooooaaahhhh... Lulu beat Petoskey! Lulu beat Petoskey! Lulu beat Petoskey!

LIZZIE
You didn't happen to buy these at a rock store?

14. "FRAUDWAY"

Lulu reveals the Heirloom.

PETOSKEY
WHERE? WHERE DID YOU GET THAT?

LULU
OH DEER.

PETOSKEY
NO ANSWERS, HUH?

LULU
A *DEER*.

PETOSKEY
SERIOUS?

LULU
SERIOUSLY A DEER.

Lulu refuses to give it back.

PETOSKEY
JUST GIVE IT BACK.
HAVE IT YOUR WAY.
YOU FRAUD...

LULU
LET ME ENJOY THE SPOILS.
THIS JEALOUSY REALLY MAKES MY MOM'S BLOOD BOIL.
"CONGRATULATIONS" IS ALL YOU NEED TO SAY.
FORGET ROCKS FOR A SECOND AND LET US ENJOY THIS PARADE.

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O PETOSKEY
IT'S BROADWAY!

As Perry drives the Ford Model T, Willy sits in the passenger side, and Cherry is in the back seat in the most elaborate costume ever.

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
GRANDE PARADE ON HARBOR DAYS!

The Van Otterloos hand out candy and theatre memorabilia to the parade crowd and real-life Audience.

JACOB
Welcome to the Harbor Days Grande Parade! Thanks for inviting me as your Grand Marshall. Before this, I was on the Addams Family national tour. That's why I'm feeling so Wednesday on a Saturday. But yes, the Grande Parade runs annually from noon to 1PM along River Street, downtown Elk Rapids. Awards will be given out to various categories including Best Float, Best Motorized, Best Non-Motorized, Best Commercial Business, Best Instrumental, and the Most Creative. *We all know who the winning family's gonna be...*

VAN OTTERLOOS
BROADWAY! BROADWAY! BROADWAY! BROADWAY!
NOTHING SHALL STAND BETWEEN US AND FAME!

Jacob hands the Most Creative Award plaque to Willy.

LULU
YOU COULD LIVE FOREVER IF YOU GAVE UP BEING A ROCK IN A HARD PLACE.

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O PETOSKEY
A ROCK IN A HARD PLACE.

PETOSKEY
LIKE MY FATHER...

Lulu considers giving back the Heirloom for Petoskey's sake.

In Lulu's perspective, as she is about to hand over the Heirloom to Petoskey, Colonizer Petey steps into her line of sight. She smashes the Heirloom on the ground, splitting the hearty Petoskey stone in half.

In Petoskey's perspective, he sees his father Petey once more. When Lulu smashes the Heirloom, Petey vanishes. Petoskey is shattered like the Petoskey before him. He is heartbroken like never before.

The parade reaches BANH MIchigan restaurant. Jasper is handing out food to the crowd and Audience with the Vinh Chin family.

Lulu waves at Jasper.

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
You're not taking my godfather, too...
SEE YOU ON...

VAN OTTERLOOS
FRAUDWAY!

Petoskey slaps Lulu. It is a bad look for Jud Fry to beat up the broken-armed Evan Hansen.

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O KIDS,LIZ,SHELBY
THIS IS FRAUDWAY!
BREAK HEARTS TODAY!
SING YOUR HEART OUT ON FRAUDWAY,
WHERE SONGS GOT NO SAY!

Liz and Shelby try to break up the fight. Suddenly, a memory washes over them.

2008 Petey comes out of nowhere and hurts Shelby. Liz redirects her attention to them.

PETEY
They stole our jobs and my little sister, too!

LIZZIE
Petosk- Petey, stop! Get your hands off her!

PETEY & PETOSKEY
She... She...

LIZZIE
Her husband is a loving hardworking man. Even if he's a transplant. If you cannot love her addition into your family, I no longer want to be an addition to this family.

Liz throws away her wedding ring.

PETEY & PETOSKEY
Not you, too...

Petey tries to hug or kiss Liz. She dismisses and tends to Shelby. Petey exits and starts up the car.

In reality, Jasper pulls Petoskey away from Lulu.

Jacob runs into the orchestra pit and blows a wind instrument.

JACOB
This ain't Broadway. It's Fraudway. The parade is over! We do not condone these acts of violence. Huh... On behalf of the Harbor Days committee, I hereby revoke my family's Most Creative Award.

A Resident removes the award plaque from Willy's grasp.

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O LIZ & PETOSKEY
LOST?
WE CAN'T LOSE.
YOU'VE HURT...

CHERRY
OUR CHANCES!

PERRY
FAMILY.

LULU
PETOSKEY, GO DROWN.

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O PETOSKEY
THIS FAMILY WILL NEVER LET THIS DOWN!

LULU (CONT'D)
PLEASE SINK!

Jasper helps Lulu get up. He dismisses Petoskey.

End of "FRAUDWAY"

15. "KICK ROCKS"

Petoskey faces Liz.

PETOSKEY
PLEASE SEE, MOM. IT'S NOT WHAT IT LOOK LIKE.
BELIEVE ME, MOM. I AIN'T MEAN TO HURT HER.
DON'T LEAVE ME, MOM! SHE STARTED EVERYTHING.

LIZZIE
SON...
GO KICK ROCKS!
KICK ROCKS!
IT DOESN'T MATTER WHO'S START IT!
AS MY CHILD, YOU KNOW BETTER...

PETOSKEY
VIOLENCE WON'T END?

LIZZIE
SON...
WHAT MATTERS: VIOLENCE IS NOT THE ANSWER!

PETOSKEY
A RAGING MONSTER'S WHAT I LOOK LIKE.
BEEN A MONSTER, WHO IS MEANT TO HURT ALL.
DO LEAVE THIS MONSTER, WHO'S STONED EVERYTHING.

LIZZIE
SON...
GO
KICK ROCKS!

The Van Otterloos join in with Liz.

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O LULU
KICK ROCKS!

LIZZIE
IT DOESN'T MATTER WHO'S START IT.

PETOSKEY
I DIDN'T START IT!

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O LULU
WHO STARTED IT?

LIZZIE
MAYBE AS MY HUSBAND'S CHILD, YOU DON'T KNOW BETTER...

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O LULU
THE VIOLENCE WON'T END!

Lulu is about to lodge a punch at Petoskey. Instead, she throws the Heirloom at him.

The Keepers of Faith, Fire, Trade appear before Petoskey.

KEEPERS
MICHILIMACKINAC...
THE PLACE OF THE GREAT TURTLE.

As the Keepers vanish, Petoskey ponders about the Mackinac Bridge.

PETOSKEY
ALL THAT MATTER'S THAT WE BRIDGE THE LOVE...
IT'S ALWAYS THE ANSWER!

Dismissing the Heirloom, Petoskey faces a body of water.

LIZZIE
SON,
KICK ROCKS!

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
KICK ROCKS!
WHY PETOSKEY?

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O LULU
KICK ROCKS!
KICK ROCKS!

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O LULU (CONT'D)
KICK ROCKS!
KICK ROCKS!

Liz reaches for Petoskey.

LIZZIE
NO!

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O LULU
KICK...

LULU
REMEMBER TO FLOAT!

LIZZIE
PETOSKEY!

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O LULU
...ROCKS!

Like his father, Petoskey sinks into the body of water.

End of "KICK ROCKS"

END OF ACT I

INTERMISSION

ACT II

SCENE 1

EXT. ELK RAPIDS - AUGUST 2016 - DAY (6 YEARS AGO)

16. "HANDS COME IN HANDY"

The Harbor Days Talent Show features a handy line-up, such as 7-year-old Lulu and Petoskey.

LULU
WELCOME TO MICHIGAN.
ARE YOU FEELING LOST?
ALWAYS REMEMBER, FRIEND:
PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

PETOSKEY
OR FACE YOUR LEFT HAND DOWN!

LULU
PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

PETOSKEY
AND YOUR LEFT HAND OVER!

Petoskey puts his left hand, palm facing, over Lulu's right hand to form Michigan's Peninsulas. They point to the respective cities.

LULU & PETOSKEY
LET'S START WITH THE THUMB.
DETROIT, DEARBORN, WARREN, PORT HURON, FLINT, HAMTRAMCK-

LULU
"Ham-trammkk?" It's pronounced: "ham-tra-mik."

PETOSKEY
Ope. Is anyone even gonna use this song?

LULU
No, but you don't want no angry Midwesterners.
So pronounce them right, Yooper boy.

PETOSKEY
Aight, troll gal...

LULU & PETOSKEY
HAMTRAMCK, ROYAL OAK, AND DON'T FORGET ANN ARBOR.
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
LET'S POINT TO THE PALM.
LANSING, MT. PLEASANT, SAGINAW, KALAMAZOO, CLAIRE, SAINT LOUIS, GRAND RAPIDS, AND LET'S FORGET WYOMING...
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

Lulu and Petoskey wear Wyoming High School gears (David Quang Pham's alma mater).

PETOSKEY
WHAT BRINGS YOU TO MICHIGAN?
WE DO HAVE THE BEST SOCKS!

LULU
DON'T FORGET THE MITTENS!

PETOSKEY
PUT YOUR LEFT PALM DOWN.

LULU
OR FACE YOUR *RIGHT* PALM UP!

PETOSKEY
PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

LULU
AND YOUR LEFT HAND OVER!

LULU & PETOSKEY
NOW AROUND THE HAND...
ST. JOSEPH, SAUGATUCK, HOLLAND, GRAND HAVEN, MUSKEGON, TRAVERSE CITY, ALPENA...

Petoskey points to himself.

LULU
WHO COULD FORGET PETOSKEY...?

LULU & PETOSKEY
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

NOW THE OTHER HAND!
MARQUETTE, ESCANABA, HOUGHTON, SAULT STE. MARIE, MACKINAC, IRON MOUNTAIN, KEWEENAW.

LULU
DID WE FORGET ANYTHING?

Petoskey brings out a Snoopy doll from *Peanuts*! He and Lulu pretend to ride rollercoasters and waterslides. They soon hold up a sign that reads: "President Mark Camille Jourden of Michigan's Adventures: Please stage us!"

PETOSKEY
MICHIGAN'S ADVENTURES!

LULU
TWO PARKS!

PETOSKEY
FOR THE PRICE OF ONE!

LULU & PETOSKEY
FUN! FUN!

LULU
MICHIGAN'S LOWER PENINSULA!

PETOSKEY
MICHIGAN'S UPPER PENINSULA!

LULU & PETOSKEY
FOR A THOUSAND TOWNSHIPS, TOWNSHIPS!

Lulu and Petoskey high-five Audience Members.

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
HIGH-FIVE EACH OTHER!
APPLAUD YOURSELVES!

LOVE MICHIGAN!
DON'T EVER FEEL LOST!
REMEMBER TO USE YOUR HANDS!
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

LULU
PUT YOUR RIGHT PALM UP.

PETOSKEY
LEFT HAND OVER!

LULU & PETOSKEY
HANDS COME IN HANDY!

Lulu and Petoskey do a Pat-a-cake, pat-a-cake, baker's man game. They run off, high-fiving Audience Members on the way out.

End of "HANDS COME IN HANDY"

SCENE 2

EXT. ELK RAPIDS - AUGUST 2022 - DAY (PRESENT)

Liz watches the 2016 recording of her kids' song on her phone.

LIZZIE
I guess Petoskey could be anywhere!

Cherry and Perry check in.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
My son?

CHERRY
No luck.

PERRY
You should've named him Limestone. He would've been easier to find.

LIZZIE
Science is not helping.

CHERRY
When did it ever?

PERRY
Maybe if we held Governor Gretchen Whitmer hostage, she'll reveal the location of Petoskey-

CHERRY
Stop trying to kidnap the governor!

Shelby attends to Liz while Cherry and Perry bicker.

LIZZIE
Petoskey always answers to Jasper, you, your sisters, but when I call?

SHELBY
Welp, when Lulu's being Lulu, she locks herself in her room and blasts Iggy Pop until the drywall melted.

LIZZIE
My son's not in his tent. Petoskey skipped out to nowhere. I don't know where he could be. I don't want him to sink low like Petey...

SHELBY
Although he's been gone, Lulu's papa hasn't gone to a single Harbor Days since Petey-

LIZZIE
Petey drowned long before he ended in the lake, Shelby. The layoffs, recession- he was angry. He shouldn't have said those things to your husband. He shouldn't have taken it out on you.

SHELBY
He was hurting. Huh, my daughter now carries that weight. She writes a library of showtunes to escape. I wish I could fine tune her.

LIZZIE
Lulu and Petoskey sure know how to strike a chord.

From the Audience, Amanda enters with an entourage of OLIGARCHS.

AMANDA
There's no one to hold us back.
(to an Audience Member)
Would you like to strike a chord through our AI music generating app for just $20.22?

LIZZIE
I can't get a hold of Petoskey but perhaps AI?

The Aunties exit.

17. "PETOSKEY"

Liz goes ask around the Audience.

LIZZIE
HAVE YOU, HAVE YOU SEEN PETOSKEY?

Liz spots and confronts Amanda, but she has a heart of stone.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
MY ROCK, MY ROCK WITH A SOFT SPOT?
MY STONE, MY STONE FULL OF HEART?
You'd expect AI be able to find missing children!

AMANDA
I didn't promise it'd find little kids but spy on them. No problemo.

LIZZIE
It only makes lost kids more lost...

As Liz searches, Petoskey gets off a bus with a map app on his phone, carrying a fishing pole. As she asks the residents glued to their phones, he approaches the Mackinac Bridge. Petoskey disappears there.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
HAVE YOU SEEN PETOSKEY?
HAVE YOU, HAVE YOU SEEN PETOSKEY?
MY ROCK, MY ROCK WITH A SOFT SPOT?
MY STONE, MY STONE FULL OF HEART?
MY HEART, MY HEART CANNOT TAKE-

Liz collapses.

[Amanda sees Liz's struggle. She revisits a memory of her and her brother collecting rocks. Conor loves Petoskey stones and wearing patterns, like Liz's son.]

Amanda comes to her aid. She drops a device by Liz, then leaves.

The Van Otterloos, without Lulu, come to her aid.

VAN OTTERLOOS
LIZ... YOU ARE NOT ALONE. WE WILL FIND YOUR COOL ROCK.

The Van Otterloos give away Petoskey stones to the Audience. They hand one to Liz.

VAN OTTERLOOS (CONT'D)
PATTERNS.
PATTERNS.
PETOSKEY HAS A PATTERN.
PATTERNS!
LET US FIND YOUR,
LET US FIND YOUR ROCK!

The Twins steal Liz's stone.

LIBERTY & BAILEY
COOL ROCK!

Liz chases after the Twins, then returns with the Petoskey stone.

LIZZIE
PETOSKEY!

VAN OTTERLOOS
LET US FIND PETOSKEY!

End of "PETOSKEY"

Everyone exits as search parties. Liz figures out how to use Amanda's device, and walks off when the tracker turns on.

SCENE 3

INT. BANH MICHIGAN RESTAURANT - DAY

Lulu enters the restaurant and sits by Jasper on the phone.

JASPER
I'll give you the BANH MIchigan secret formula if you find him. Of course *alive*, you sicko.

Jasper hangs up.

JASPER (CONT'D)
You found Petoskey?

Lulu faces down on the table, crying.

JASPER (CONT'D)
Don't lose yourself, Lulu...

LULU
I lost my cousin. I lost my family. All hope is lost.

JASPER
Your family is mine and you have only gained more of my respect. And everyone's a peninsula away, whereas my family's continents.

LULU
Don't we have planes now?

JASPER
I ain't old. There've been planes since I was born. That's besides the point. I lost *touch*.

LULU
How do you get a sense of how your family's doing?

JASPER
Not a sense of touch but tastes and smells. You know what my family always said?

18. "NORTH SOUTH EAST WEST"

LULU
YOUR FAMILY SAID WHAT?

JASPER
NORTH SOUTH EAST OR WEST.
IT DOESN'T MATTER WHERE YOU COME FROM
AS LONG AS YOU BREAK BREAD.

LULU
YOU AND YA BANH MI NEEDA GIVE IT A REST.

JASPER
SOMEONE'S COMPASS AIN'T PASSING MY TEST.

Jacob enters the restaurant.

JACOB
SHALOM.

LULU
BONJOUR!

JASPER
CHAU, JACOB!

JACOB
LOOKING FOR OUR MISSING COUSIN WORKED ME UP AN APPETITE.

JASPER
I'M SURE KOSHER WILL GIVE US CLOSURE.

JACOB
MAKE MY BREAD A BRIDGE ROLL.

JASPER
NOT FEELING FRENCH TODAY?

LULU
THE BRITISH INVASION WAS SO YESTERDAY.

Jasper makes a Banh Mi for Jacob.

JASPER
NORTH SOUTH EAST OR WEST.
I DON'T CARE IF YOU'RE STRAIGHT OR CURVED
SO LONG AS YOU TRY THEM BAGUETTES.

JACOB
Just cause I do musical theatre does not make me gay. Look at Lulu, wanting to be a musical writer, does that make her-

LULU
Yup, I'm gay.

JASPER
Open-and-shut case.

JACOB
Okay...

LULU
Banh Mi turned me gay.

JASPER
Case back open...

JACOB
Haha! Welp...
TODA FOR THE BRIDGE!

LULU
THE BRIDGE?

JASPER
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

LULU
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

JASPER
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

LULU
THE MACKINAC.

LULU & JASPER
THE MACKINAC BRIDGE.

NORTH SOUTH EAST OR WEST.
IT DOESN'T MATTER WHERE YOU GO
SO LONG AS YOU LISTEN TO THE BREAD.

End of "NORTH SOUTH EAST WEST"

Liz enters the restaurant.

LULU & JASPER (CONT'D)
We know where Petoskey is.

LIZZIE
I have a feeling, it's...

JASPER
The bridge...

LIZZIE
I...

JASPER
I'll go to Mackinac for you.

LULU
And I need to go apologize...

Liz punches her hand into her other hand. Lulu acknowledges it.

LULU (CONT'D)
Apologize with some deserved violence.

JASPER
Banh Mi, you never fail me!

Jasper kisses a Banh Mi, then runs out with Lulu.

LIZZIE
Thanks for the Turk cameras, Amanda...

(Narrating)
Mackinac... Where I lost the love of my life. But also, where I found love and built a life together.

2006 Petey rushes in and hugs Liz. They assemble a boat together.

SCENE 4

EXT. MACKINAC ISLAND - MARCH 2006 - DAY (16 YEARS AGO)

Liz and Petey sail on their boat that they made at their shipyard.

LIZZIE
A fun fact I learnt in the Great Lakes Museum in Toledo is that on average one ship has sunk every eleven days for the past 250 years here.

PETEY
Any cars in the statistics?

LIZZIE
I don't remember but whoever's the first to sink a car sounds like my type.

PETEY
How about if I sank these gunships?

Petey flexes his muscles.

LIZZIE
I see no gunships but a pacifist.

PETEY
I hate this war in the Middle East. Why can't the government target the Midwest for a change?

LIZZIE
Well, the tide is turning on the public sentiment towards the war, but at least the shipbuilding business is booming.

PETEY
We have to win. You can count on our shipyard.

LIZZIE
Are we even gonna conquer Mackinac Strait? The water is rough here.

PETEY
And it’s still winter.

LIZZIE
Cold hard fact: at forty degrees, it only takes six minutes for hypothermia to kill a sailor who has fallen into Lake Superior waters in the winter season.

Petey freezes in place.

LIZZIE (CONT’D)
Thanks for being up for this.

PETEY
No, it’s you.

LIZZIE & PETEY
Nah, we asked at the same time. Jinx!

PETEY
You hear that?

LIZZIE
Ah! The boat’s leaking.

Liz patches up a hole in the boat.

PETEY
You’re a natural at this.

LIZZIE
And you are... Uh...

PETEY
(Blushing)
Yes...?

19. “NATURAL BEAUTY”

Liz taps Petey’s nose.

LIZZIE
YOU ARE BEAUTIFUL.

PETEY
(Gay)
YOU THINK I’M BEAUTIFUL?

LIZZIE
JUST TAKE THE COMPLIMENT.
YOU DON’T HAVE TO GET ALL WEIRD ABOUT IT.

PETEY
WHATEVER YOU SAY, MS. NATURAL.

Petey motions to Liz that he has questions. They may nod “yes.”

PETEY (CONT’D)
AM I BEAUTIFUL AS THE GREAT LAKES?

LIZZIE
AM I NATURAL AS THE GLACIERS WHO CARVED IT?

PETEY
AM I BEAUTIFUL LIKE HER SNOW?

LIZZIE
AM I NATURAL LIKE HER HILLS AND COVES?

PETEY
WAS I A BEAUTY SHOVELING IN A BLIZZARD?

Petey shovels.

LIZZIE
WAS I A NATURAL CATCHING HAIL LIKE A WIZARD?

Liz catches hail like a baseball.

PETEY
HAIL YEAH!

LIZZIE
YOU ARE A BEAUTY
IN NATURE.

PETEY (CONT’D)
YOU ARE A NATURAL
AND YOU ARE BEAUTIFUL.

Liz looks at the time and taps her feet impatiently. Petey points to the landscapes.

LIZZIE (CONT’D)
BREATHTAKING VALLEYS!
PRETTY FAST RIVERS!
ENORMOUS MOUNTAINS!
MASSIVE PERCHED SAND DUNES!

PETEY (CONT’D)
SWOOPING LIKE A HAWK!
FLOATING LIKE AN OTTER!
CLIMBING LIKE A WOLF!
RUNNING LIKE A DEER!

LIZZIE (CONT’D)
DUMPSTER TRUCKS PILE-UP ON I-75!

PETEY
LIVE LIKE A RACCOON!

LIZZIE
HAIL NO!

LIZZIE (CONT’D)
YOU ARE SO SLOW.
ARE YOU GONNA ASK ME
SOMETHING?

PETEY
YOU ARE A-
BEAUTY?
THIS IS UNNATURAL.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
AM I BEAUTIFUL OR NOT?

PETEY
YOU ARE NATURAL AS THE UH...?

LIZZIE
NEVER BEAUTIFUL AT ALL?

PETEY
YOU ARE NATURAL AS THE RINGS OF SATURN.

LIZZIE
AM I A BEAUTY WEARING NO RING?

PETEY
YOU ARE BEAUTIFUL AS IMPATIENT.

LIZZIE
YOU'RE STILL SLOW.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
JUST ACT NATURAL.

PETEY
JUST ACT SURPRISED.

As the boat approaches Mackinac Island, the Van Otterloos and Liz Glynn's family run out with proposal posters. One reads: "Will you marry me, Petey?" The other: "Will you marry me, Lizzie?"

Liz and Petey get on their knees simultaneously and pull out their rings. Flustered, they laugh. They set up the wedding ceremony on Mackinac Island.

In their wedding attires, Liz and Petey walk down the aisle and center themselves. They kiss.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
WE ARE A NATURAL
AND WE ARE BEAUTIFUL.

PETEY (CONT'D)
WE ARE A BEAUTY
IN NATURE.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
WE ARE NOW MARRIED!

LIZZIE & PETEY
YOU ARE A NATURAL BEAUTY.

As Liz kisses Petey's cheek, he stares bittersweetly at the Mackinac Bridge in the distance.

Everyone disappears into the natural beauty.

End of "NATURAL BEAUTY"

SCENE 5

EXT. MACKINAC BRIDGE - AUGUST 2022 - DAY (PRESENT)

20. "ROCK BOTTOM"

On the creaky bridge, with a fishing rod in hand, Petoskey looks down the Mackinac Strait.

PETOSKEY
EVERY BRIDGE HIDES WATER.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (O.S.)
UNDER.

PETOSKEY
EVERY STONE SHOWS PAIN.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (O.S.)
SHAPED BY RAIN.
EVERYDAY THIS BEDROCK SLEEPWALKS.

PETOSKEY
SO SICK AND TIRED OF STICKING LOVED ONES IN HARD PLACES.
I DON'T WANNA EVER SHOW MY FACE.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (O.S.)
CAST YOUR FATE.

PETOSKEY
HIDE AWAY MY SHAME.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
YOUR HATE.

Lulu runs in.

Petoskey notices Jasper in the Ford Model T in the distance. They wave. He is then on his guard.

Lulu is about to sock Petoskey in the face. Deservedly so. Instead, she hands him the Heirloom.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)
(Gospel)
PETOSKEY...
PETOSKEY...
THE JEWEL OF MICHIGAN...

Lulu looks around to see who is singing and fogging up the bridge.

Petoskey hooks the Heirloom on the fishing pole and cast the line down the Strait, surprising Lulu.

End of "ROCK BOTTOM"

21. "FAMILY'S IN THE FOSSILS"

The bridge fogs up, separating Petoskey and Lulu from Jasper.

Petoskey's fishing pole is tugged then pulled out of sight.

MICHILIMACKINAC, the Great Turtle, towers above the Kids. The Turtle sounds like Petey...

KEEPERS (V.O.)
MICHILIMACKINAC... THE PLACE OF THE GREAT TURTLE...

PETOSKEY
THE GREAT TURTLE...

LULU
(Whispering)
Turtles are slow. If we make a run for it-

The Turtle blocks their path.

MICHILIMACKINAC
I'm not like my slow cousin, the Tortoise. Are you hear to join me and bridge these two lands?

LULU
We're on top of a bridge.

MICHILIMACKINAC
I mean spiritually. Ever since the glaciers melted, I've held these two peninsulas together. When humans built bridges of their own, I was no longer bound to the physical world.

PETOSKEY
Is that what my dad's doing? Bridging the spirit world?

MICHILIMACKINAC
You must be Petoskey. I've heard so much about you, yet he hasn't met you. But he heard my call, and we met as bodies of water.

PETOSKEY
Why did you take my dad away?

MICHILIMACKINAC
WHEN YOUR LOVED ONE PASSES...

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D) LULU & PETOSKEY
NO LONGER LEAVING FOOTPRINTS NO LONGER...
ON THE WORLD.

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
THE WORLD NO LONGER SPINS.

MICHILIMACKINAC
YOUR FAMILY DON'T LAY FOREVER IN TOMBS.

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D) LULU & PETOSKEY
THE DEAD'S SET IN STONE AND THE DEAD LIVE ON?
FOSSILIZED.

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D)
SO EVERYONE'S FAMILIES REMEMBERED IN THE FOSSILS.

LULU & PETOSKEY
FAMILY'S IN THE FOSSILS?

MICHILIMACKINAC
THEM FOSSILS.

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D)
I'm here to take everyone suffering from pain.

PETOSKEY
Can you take mom's pain away?

MICHILIMACKINAC
If she wants to take a shortcut here like her lover. Be my guest. Anyone can be my guest.

LULU & PETOSKEY
No no no.

LULU
We don't need another soul to be your guest.

MICHILIMACKINAC
One thinks shortcuts save time, but it makes all lose their ways anyways.

LULU
It's like AI...

MICHILIMACKINAC
Glad you have the audacious intelligence to put A and I together...
(MORE)

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D)
Looks like the peninsulas have gifted me two sacrifices: a farm boy from the north and a city gal from the south.

PETOSKEY
No no no. Take me only. After all, my father's here. And plus, Lulu smells like car oil.

LULU
I'm gonna light you up, Petoskey!

The Turtle smells Banh Mi.

MICHILIMACKINAC
That delicious smell of a Banh Mi.

PETOSKEY
You know Banh Mi?

MICHILIMACKINAC
It must be Jasper. Petey speaks highly of him. Is Jasper open to being sacrificed?

LULU & PETOSKEY
No!

LULU
Take me instead!

MICHILIMACKINAC
So jealous my sister's living it up in Vietnam. I could've settled in the Caribbeans, by Sierra Leone, Greece, Brazil, Israel, Ecuador. But no... I chose Michigan. The food ain't bad, the weather could be better.

By the way, I'm kidding. No sacrifices here, so long as you stop these data centers. They are rather noisy. It drives me insane.

PETOSKEY
For all humans...

LULU
...it drives us insane, too.

MICHILIMACKINAC
Keep the Great Lakes *great*, my children.

WHEN YOUR LOVED ONE PASSES...

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D)
NO LONGER LEAVING FOOTPRINTS
ON THE WORLD.

LULU & PETOSKEY
NO LONGER...

LULU & PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
THE WORLD NO LONGER SPINS.

MICHILIMACKINAC
YOUR FAMILY DON'T LAY FOREVER IN TOMBS.

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D) LULU & PETOSKEY
THE DEAD'S SET IN STONE AND THE DEAD LIVE ON?
FOSSILIZED.

MICHILIMACKINAC (CONT'D)
SO EVERYONE'S FAMILIES REMEMBERED IN THE FOSSILS.

LULU & PETOSKEY
FAMILY'S IN THE FOSSILS.

KEEPERS (V.O.)
MICHILIMACKINAC... THE PLACE OF THE GREAT TURTLE...

The Turtle sinks back into the Mackinac Strait.

End of "FAMILY'S IN THE FOSSILS"

The fog clears up. Petoskey hugs Lulu.

LULU
I'd punch you off this bridge...

PETOSKEY
Thanks for having mercy on me...

Lulu and Petoskey walk away from the Mackinac Bridge. She punches him.

PETOSKEY (CONT'D)
Ouch! Ope...

LULU
Told ya I'd punch ya off the bridge!

JASPER
Hold your vengeance for Amanda Wayland and her cronies!

LULU, PETOSKEY, JASPER
Let's save Elk Rapids and the world!

They drive off.

END OF ACT II

ACT III

SCENE 1

EXT. ELK RAPIDS - EVENING

In front of a crowd, Amanda and her Oligarchs exhibit models of their data centers.

AMANDA
We will save money! Lotsa money!

RESIDENT
Where’d you come up with such predictions?

RESIDENT (CONT’D)
Who made your models?

RESIDENT (CONT’D)
How’d ya decide ya fit today?

AMANDA & OLIGARCHS
Ope... AI does the work for us.

Jasper drives in the Ford Model T with Lulu and Petoskey.

LULU & PETOSKEY
AI does not work!

AMANDA
Neither do kids... Not yet, until we bring back-

OLIGARCHS
Child laborrrrrrrrrrr! Muahahahahahahahahaha!!!

OLIGARCH
Ya need to work on ya evil laugh. Let AI help!

JASPER
We don’t need AI determining good and evil anymore. We need our Lake House back.

AMANDA
You lost the Petoskey. Nothing matches a trade like a cool rock.

JASPER
How about my BANH MI restaurant?

LULU & PETOSKEY
Jasper?!

AMANDA
The Southeast gem of the Midwest? Besides water, our data center needs her cafeteria.

JASPER
I'll also throw in my golf course.

AMANDA
Such small businessowner owning lotsa properties. It makes a monopoly blush in envy.

JASPER'S DECEASED LOVED ONE comes out of nowhere.

JASPER
My love... You've returned.

The Figure hugs Jasper and suddenly a tablet appears in his hands. Lulu and Petoskey shake Jasper out of a trance.

LULU & PETOSKEY
That's not your love!

LULU
It's gullible, falling for these digital scams.

PETOSKEY
They're unreal. They've been dead a long time.

JASPER
I've just signed away BANH MIchigan.

RESIDENTS
With nothing to show for-

Most Resident's phones including Jasper's ding. Deceased Figures, including Jasper's, tend to the grieving.

JASPER
It's not the first my family has lost the restaurant...

AMANDA
Anyone else oblige to give up their homes?

Cherry shows up.

CHERRY
All of us needs our houses. You stole these people's homes and you better give them back.

AMANDA
These people have fairly traded in their deeds for another chance at seeing their loved ones who passed on. Who could put a price on that?

CHERRY
You did! A house for an artificial soul!

Petey comes out of nowhere.

AMANDA
Would you say he's artificial?

CHERRY
Petey?

PETEY
I should've chosen my life over the house. But you've got a second chance to pick my life over my house.

Petey pulls out a tablet with a contract. Cherry takes it and prepares to sign it.

The rest of the Van Otterloos show up.

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O LULU, PETOSKEY, LIZ
The Lake House is not what we call "home." The people who live in it are our home.

AMANDA
Welp, settles it. I can call Elk Rapids home.

RESIDENTS
You sure?

AMANDA
Lemme ask AI. Hey, would you call this town my home?

AI
Good evening, Amanda Wayland, you gorgeous tech giant. Of course, I would call this town your home. And everyone's home-

AMANDA
She's hallucinating, again.

LULU
You rely on AI cause ya got no N-I.

OLIGARCHS
N-I?

CHERRY
Natural Intelligence.

OLIGARCHS
Wut???

AMANDA
Don’t ever say the N word ever again.

VAN OTTERLOOS
Natural beauty!

Amanda and the Oligarchs convulse.

AMANDA & OLIGARCHS
Ope ugh! Ope ugh! Ope ugh! Ope ugh! Ope uugghh!

AMANDA
Scapegoat dot AI, now!

Everyone’s phones ping.

RESIDENT
Headline: the Van Otterloos stole from the kids’ charity?!

RESIDENT (CONT’D)
The Van Otterloos have been dumping Model T oil into Elk Lake?!

RESIDENT (CONT’D)
The Van Otterloos burn down an orphanage?!

AMANDA
Scapegoat dot AI now with hyper realistic photos included.

VAN OTTERLOOS
The people of Elk Rapids are on our side-

The Residents surround the Van Otterloos like predatory creatures.

AMANDA
And society- The world is on capitalism’s side. It sets a late stage for my amazing creatures.

CHERRY
Looks like Ms. Photoshopper’s gonna kill us all-

LULU & PETOSKEY
Aunt Cherry?

PERRY & SHELBY
Before we die...

JACOB
Wanna wear our ridiculous costumes...

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O CHERRY, LIZ
For ol' time sake?

CHERRY
Back trunk of the Ford Model T is all our costumes for the last four decades...

As the Residents surround the Van Otterloos, ready to attack, the Van Otterloos put on old costumes from past Harbor Days. The Residents admire them.

RESIDENT
We can't hurt the Van Otterloos.

RESIDENT (CONT'D)
They are the spirit of this town.

AMANDA
Look at them. Using their own humanity to bring messy creativity to the world. What a shame.

RESIDENT
What a shame? It's *who* and that's you.

AMANDA
Me? The shame would be on me if I leave the city of stones unturned.

RESIDENT
We don't need another city turned into a data center.

RESIDENTS
Yeah!

AMANDA
Data Rapids has a nice ring to it.

RESIDENT
The Van Otterloos are our ring...

RESIDENT (CONT'D)
And we're committed to them.

RESIDENT (CONT'D)
Van Otterloos! Van Otterloos! Van Otterloos!

22. "LEAVE NO STONES UNTURNED"

AMANDA
No blood, sweat, and tears...

VAN OTTERLOOS W/O LIZ
Just rocks and no fear.

AMANDA
Do you want water to continue eroding your family? People you hold dearly?

LULU
What's dear to us is the water.

LULU & PETOSKEY
Water's our life force.

AMANDA
All water brings is death. I will drain every puddle, boil every lake, chop every tree... to keep my brother's dreams alive... to bring him to life!

SHELBY
Don't touch our watershed.

CHERRY
And there won't be bloodshed.

PERRY
Why don't you shed that lizard skin of yours, tech oligarch?

AMANDA
Shed this. Activate Elk dot AI!

Everyone's phones ping, distracting them.

RESIDENT
Check out this cute elk doing karate!

RESIDENT (CONT'D)
My elk is doing a comedy routine!

RESIDENT (CONT'D)
And this is Aretha Franklin as an elk!

Amanda and the Oligarchs make their way through the distracted crowd to the Ford Model T.

Lulu and Petoskey block Amanda.

PETOSKEY
We don't have our phones.

LULU
Our parents grounded us.

Holding a frying pan, Milly sneaks behind Amanda and the Oligarchs. She knocks them out.

LULU & PETOSKEY
Grammy Milly!

Lulu and Petoskey try to hug Milly.

MILLY
Ope ope ope... You need baths. But first, want me to whip up a batch of your favorite cookies?! I don't want your dirty butts in the backseat, so get in the trunk.

LULU & PETOSKEY
Anything for you, Grammy!

Lulu and Petoskey get in the trunk. Milly closes it then vanishes.

Amanda and the Oligarchs get up.

AMANDA
Works every time...

The residents face Amanda.

VAN OTTERLOOS
Those wealth hoarders are kidnapping our kids!

RESIDENTS
Get 'em!

Amanda drives Ford Model T away from the pursuing crowd.

OLIGARCH
Is it morally right to lock kids in the trunk?

OLIGARCH (CONT'D)
Who cares?! We can sell them for parts!

OLIGARCH (CONT'D)
I love being rich!

AMANDA
Elk Rapids, check. Next, Grand Rapids!

AI
Redirecting!

Fireworks soar and explode around.

Liz gets off a bus nearby. She pulls out her phone tracker. She sees the Ford Model T drive by as she expected. She runs after them.

AMANDA
No way... Is that...?

LULU & PETOSKEY
Mackinac Bridge!

OLIGARCHS
We have to cross!

AMANDA
The bridge crossed my heart and made me hope to die. I can’t. I won’t. I refuse!

OLIGARCHS
We have no choice. They’re gaining on us!

AMANDA
The living behind us or the dead ahead?!

The GHOST OF HENRY FORD manifests inside the Ford Model T, chained up like a Charles Dickens ghost.

AMANDA (CONT’D)
The ghost of Henry Ford???!

OLIGARCHS
Our lord and savior...

AMANDA
What happened to you?

FORD
This is what anti-Semitism and being anti-union does to you. Distribute your wealth or else!

OLIGARCH
Well, at least there’s cryptocurrency.

FORD
We have the internet in Hell, too. You think angels invented WIFI?!

AMANDA
Get off my plane of existence!

Amanda erratically drives the Ford Model T while the Oligarchs try to pickpocket Henry Ford until the car reaches the Mackinac Bridge.

SCENE 2

EXT. MACKINAC BRIDGE - DAY

Amanda crashes the Ford Model T off the side of the bridge. She and the Oligarchs climb out. The Ford falls further down, making it hard to reach. Henry Ford chases away the Oligarchs.

FORD
Distribute your wealth or else!

Liz reaches the wreckage.

AMANDA
You changed my GPS destination, didn't you?

LIZZIE
Not U. A I.

AMANDA
Your rock and pearl are still in the trunk!

LIZZIE
Face the water.

AMANDA
You face the water!

LIZZIE
Hold onto my legs while I reach down.

Amanda pulls Liz down to get to the Ford trunk. She almost lets go of Liz. Shelby runs in and grabs Liz, assisting Amanda.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
Shelby?!

SHELBY
Shall we?

LIZZIE
I can't open the trunk!

Willy *runs* in. Using a remote, he opens the trunk, revealing a dizzy Lulu and Petoskey.

AMANDA
It's an automatic?!

WILLY
My dear Grammy Milly hotwired our baby.

Liz and Shelby pull up the Kids.

The Ford Model T abruptly falls to the Mackinac Strait below.

Liz embraces Petoskey while Shelby embraces Lulu.

LIZZIE
My rock. Don't ever try to sink so low again.

PETOSKEY
I'm so sorry for hurting Lulu, mom.

LULU
I get to choose what you wear next year!

LIZZIE & SHELBY
We'll make it as humiliating as possible.

PETOSKEY
Humility... I wish I embodied my dad. I'm sorry-

LIZZIE
I didn't marry Petey for his body. I loved him for his soul. And you, Petoskey, have his soul.

The rest of the Van Otterloos and Residents reach the wreckage.

WILLY
Farewell, Ford Model T...

AMANDA
I'm sorry.

WILLY
Mackinac Bridge has taken many things from me. I'm glad it didn't take any more of you.

Collapsing on her knees, Amanda cries uncontrollably.

LIBERTY & BAILEY
You can cry in Hell!

AMANDA
This was where my brother left home. Bridges are supposed to unite lands...

LIZZIE & AMANDA
...not divide souls.

AMANDA
Water took everything from-

Cherry finally extends a hand to Amanda. They tear up.

CHERRY
Me too. The water also gave us a new life.

The Aunties help Amanda up.

CHERRY, PERRY, SHELBY
Let's not divide our souls, no more.

Shelby holds Lulu's hand.

Liz holds Petoskey's hand.

LIZZIE
Son... We're taking the shortcut.

End of "LEAVE NO STONES UNTURNED"

23. "WATER TO MY SOUL"

The Van Otterloos and Amanda walk on the bridge, leaving the Residents behind.

LIZZIE
WHEN?

CHERRY
WHEN?

PERRY
WHEN?

SHELBY
WHEN?

LIZZIE, AUNTIES, AMANDA
WHEN WILL I EVER LET GO?

Michilimackinac and the Mackinac Ghosts appear in the mist.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
WHEN YOU OPEN YOUR EYES AND SEE THE PAIN SHOW...

AMANDA
WHERE?

CHERRY
WHERE?

MACKINAC GHOSTS
WHERE?

PERRY
WHERE?

SHELBY
WHERE?

MACKINAC GHOSTS
WHERE?

LIZZIE, AUNTIES, AMANDA
WHERE DO ALL MY TEARS FLOW?

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)
FLOW?

The Ghosts step aside to reveal Petey in all his glory.

MACKINAC GHOSTS (CONT'D)
WELL YOU JUST HAVE TO ASK THIS POOR SOUL...

LIZZIE
MY POOR SOUL...

PETEY
NOW A HAPPY SOUL...

LIZZIE & PETEY
YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...

LIZZIE
WHERE YOU GO.

PETEY
I'LL FLOW!

AUNTIES & MACKINAC GHOSTS
NO MATTER WHERE I GO I WILL FLOW...

LIZZIE
UPSTREAM.

PETEY
DOWNSTREAM.

MACKINAC GHOSTS
YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...

Liz and Petey kiss.

LIZZIE & PETEY
YOU ARE WATER TO MY SOUL...
MY SOUL...
YOU ARE MY SOUL!

Petey hugs Cherry and Perry. He and Shelby lock eyes. She lovingly slaps him before hugging him. They all share a final dance before he hands his broken Heirloom to Liz.

Liz joins Petoskey and Shelby joins Lulu.

Liz, Petoskey, Shelby, and Lulu wave as Petey vanishes with the other Ghosts once more into the foggy bridge.

Liz puts the Heirloom on Petoskey.

Amanda tosses her phone off the bridge. Conor's shadow appears in the mist. Amanda runs to him, disappearing in the fog.

The Van Otterloos continue on. They finally cross the bridge.

End of "WATER TO MY SOUL"

END OF ACT III

EPILOGUE

SCENE 1

EXT. ELK LAKE HOUSE - JANUARY 2037 - DAY

23A. "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE 2"

The Van Otterloos prepare themselves for the Michigan Bicentennial Parade.

LIZZIE
(Narrating)
Raise your hands if you've ever lost a loved one to suicide.

The Company hugs Audience Members who raise their hands.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
We can cross the bridge. Year after year, moment after moment, we can still harbor good days.

VAN OTTERLOOS
You can cross the bridge!

LIZZIE
Huh... Beats going through Wisconsin.

LULU & PETOSKEY
Everyone's cheesy there!

LIZZIE
Amanda ripped apart the agreement, so Elk Rapids and the Lake House are ours again. The kids did it: they saved the world from one data center! Many more to go...

And Lulu ended up turning our life story into a musical for her high school senior project. Then, she developed it at U of M...

VAN OTTERLOOS
Ew...

Lulu flips them off before turning her hand back into a mitten.

LIZZIE
Two of her musicals, *Dearborn* and *Elk Rapids*, *about a deer colony and anthropomorphic lakes*? They are now touring in a town near you.
(MORE)

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
These musicals helped raise funds to keep the Lake House afloat when the time came when Willy no longer pays property taxes.

Cherry secretly holds a tablet and places Willy-Milly's photo on it.

Willy and Milly manifest, lost once again in the Audience.

Cherry waves. Perry and Shelby run in and mess with Cherry.

Lulu and Petoskey fix up the Lake House.

LAWMAKERS swear in Amanda.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
Amanda was sworn in as our lieutenant governor. She doesn't show up to break ties in the Senate and the taxpayers pay for her lavish vacations. She'd be the perfect Vice President.

AMANDA
Don't give me any ideas. Let AI do the work!

LIZZIE
At least, she's using some power to push universal mental healthcare.

CHERRY
No more AI!

SHELBY
Until you've learnt to do things by yourself!

PERRY
Next time, I'm kidnapping the governor *and you*.

Cherry and Shelby glare at Perry.

AMANDA
I've moved all the data centers to Ohio...

The Aunties rejoice around Amanda.

LULU
Can't have a musical called *Michigan* without mentioning how...

LULU & PETOSKEY
...Ohio succccckkkkkkssssss!

LIZZIE
Get to work you two.

Lulu and Petoskey finish the Lake House.

Liz tears up. She pulls out a Ohio State University flag and blows her nose.

LIZZIE (CONT'D)
Petoskey found a home in the shipyard like me and his father. And he used our shipbuilding skills to fix up the Lake House.

The rest of the Van Otterloos come and watch the Great Lakes together. They hug each other, especially Lulu.

VAN OTTERLOOS
What an honor to be a Van Otterloo like you.

LULU
Raise your hand if you feel hopeless...

PETOSKEY
Raise it if you ever felt hopeless...

The Company hugs Audience Members who raise their hands.

LIZZIE
The Great Lakes is water to our souls...

End of "LIFE IS COMPLETE - REPRISE 2"

SCENE 2

EXT. LANSING - JANUARY 26, 2037 - DAY

The Michigan Bicentennial Parade ramps up in the state capital.

Jacob is dressed like Eminem.

JACOB
My palms be sweaty, knees weak, arms are heavy.

Cherry hands spaghetti to Jacob.

JACOB (CONT'D)
Love my mom's spaghetti~

Welcome to Michigan's Bicentennial Celebration! Thanks for inviting me as your Grand Marshall. Last I hosted a parade it was Elk Rapids Harbor Days in 2022. Since then, I have won several Tony Awards and a few Razzies.
(MORE)

JACOB (CONT'D)
Them cameras make my hands look big.

Anywho, as you know, Michigan officially became the 26th state in the United States on January 26, 1837. As this year is the 200th anniversary of our statehood, we thought what better way to celebrate the Mitten then to share the best of our home state! Today is Pure Michigan!

We have floats and organizations representing the nearly three hundred cities and a thousand townships from all over our Great Lakes state!

And here comes Elk Rapids with the world-class Van Otterloo family!

The Van Otterloo family resembles the state's best from Aretha Franklin, Charles Lindbergh, Madonna, Stevie Wonder, to Christopher Wright (author of Pham's favorite book series, *Michigan Chillers*).

28-year-old Petoskey, his PARTNER, and their CHILD(REN) march alongside Lulu and her PARTNER.

The Aunties drive in the battered Ford Model T.

JACOB (CONT'D)
Who are we?!

MICHIGANDERS
(Correcting)
Who am I?!

24. "MICHIGAN"

MICHIGANDERS
OPE.
BRR...
WINTER IN OUR BONES.

LIZZIE
WHO M I?

MICHIGANDERS
WATER TO OUR SOULS!

PERRY
AM I KEEPING IT CHILL!

MICHIGANDERS
M I? M I?

CHERRY
AM I HEARTWARMING!

MICHIGANDERS
M I? M I?

SHELBY
AM I FULL OF FREE WILL!

MICHIGANDERS
M I? M I?
M I MICHIGAN!
M-I-C-H-G-A-N MICHIGAN!

End of “MICHIGAN”

LOVE MICHIGAN